

THE GATES

Volume 1: Ped Wala Park



Kisi ko andar raste chalna pada, tabhi kisi aur ko seedha rasta mila

THE GATES

VOLUME ONE · PED WALA PARK



THE GATES

Volume 1 : Ped Wala Park

पेड वाला पार्क

ANSH JHA AND COOPERATORS

*“Kisi ko lambe rasta chalna pada, tabhi kisi aur ko seedha
rasta mila.”*

Disclaimer & Copyright

THE GATE SERIES · PATNA

This novel, THE GATES - Volume 1, is a work of fiction.

All characters, incidents, places, and events in this book are fictional or used in a fictional manner. Any resemblance to actual persons, living or dead, or actual events is purely coincidental.

Age Rating: 13+

This book contains mild horror, mystery, emotional scenes, and themes of friendship and loss.

It is recommended for readers aged 13 and above. Reader discretion is advised.

Copyright © 2026 by Ansh Jha and his cooperators / Team.

All rights reserved. No part of this book may be reproduced, copied, stored, or transmitted in any form or by any means - electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, or otherwise - without the prior written permission of the author.

The original idea, story concept, plot, characters (including Chintu, Sujoy, Veer, The 50

Members Gang, The Park, The Talab) and the title "THE GATES" are the intellectual property of Ansh Jha.

Any attempt to copy, steal, or reproduce this idea / story will be considered a copyright violation and strict action will be taken.

This story was created for entertainment purposes only.

Thank you for respecting the author's work.

Foreword

CHINTU KI ZUBAANI · MEMBER NO. 1, 50 MEMBERS GANG

Agar tum ye kitaab padh rahe ho, toh matlab park ab safe hai.

Maine ye kitaab nahi likhi. Hum 50 logon ne milke ji hai.

Log puchenge - ye sach hai ya kahani? Main bolunga - Patna ke us park me jaake bench pe baitho. Shaam ko jab hawa chalegi, tumhe 25 alag-alag aawazein sunai dengi. Koi hasega, koi bolega "abe lambe se chal."

Wo hum hi hain.

Sujoy mera sabse pehla dost tha jo ped bana. Usne jaate jaate ek hi baat boli thi - "Dost ke liye gate ban jaana, ye haar nahi hai."

Us din samajh aaya, superhero woh nahi jo udta hai. Superhero woh hai jo khada rehta hai, jab sab shortcut dhoondh rahe hote hain.

Is kitaab me 30 part hain. Har part me ek dost kam hua hai, ek ped badha hai. Rona aayega.

Par aakhri part me jab talab dikhega, toh lagega - sab worth tha.

Agar tum school me ho, college me ho, aur tumhe lagta hai tumhara dost bheed me kho raha hai, toh uska haath pakad lo. Ho sakta hai kal tumhe uske liye ped banna pade.

Aur haan, shortcut ab safe hai. Seedha jaa sakte ho.

Par kabhi-kabhi lambe se jaana. Wahan ab bhi hamari yaadein khadi hain.

- Chintu

Member No. 1, 50 Members Gang

Preface

WRITER KI BAAT

Ye kahani Patna ke ek park ki nahi hai.

Ye kahani har us gali ki hai jahan maa ne bola tha - "Shortcut se mat jaana, lambe se jaana."

Hum haste the. Bolte the - "Kuch nahi hota."

Par kuch hota hai.

Kuch raste sirf raste nahi hote. Wo intezaar karte hain. Khule rehte hain. Aur ek din kisi ko rokna padta hai.

Is kahani me 25 ladke ped ban gaye. Koi zabardasti nahi. Koi jaadu nahi. Bas dosti me ek ne bola - "Tu ja, main rokta hu."

Chintu, Veer, Sujoy, Ajeya - ye naam kalpanik ho sakte hain, par ye attitude nahi hai. Har mohalle me ek Chintu hai jo bolta hai - "Pehle dost, baad me rasta."

Ye book maine un sab ke liye likhi hai jo lambe raste se gaye, taaki unke chhote bhai seedhe raste se jaa sakein.

Volume 1 yahin khatam hota hai, ek khali park me. Par yaad rahega.

Kyuki ped gir sakte hain, dost nahi.

- Writer

Patna, 2026

Contents

विषय - सूची

TAP ANY LINE TO JUMP • « » AT THE PAGE CORNERS TURN PAGES

Foreword • Chintu ki Zubaani	6
Preface • Writer ki Baat	7
Volume 1 ka Naqsha (Parts 1–30)	10

VOLUME 1 • PED WALA PARK

1	Shortcut	13	13–20	Ek Ek Karke	16
2	Afwaah	13	21	Khali Park	16
3	Pehla Ped	13	22	Talab Bula Raha Hai	16
4	Ginti	13	23	Plan	16
5	Rule	14	24	Dhokha	17
6	Veer	14	25	6 Bache	17
7	Hawa	14	26	Veer Wapas	17
8	Taweez	14	27	Aakhri Gate	17
9	13th Bench	15	28	Subah	18
10	Samjha	15	29	Naya Ladka	18
11	Teacher	15	30	Reflection	18
12	Diary	15			

VOLUME 2 • WOHI GALI JO THI HI NAHI

1	Woh Gali Jo Thi Hi Nahi (<i>Extended Director's Cut</i>)	20	18	Asli Sach	62
2	...	31	19	Patna Par Kabza	63
			20	Sacrifice	64

3	...	36	21	Sab Theek	65
4	Aakhri Raat	40	22	10 Saal Baad	66
5	Jo Naam Reh Gaye The	42	22	Phir Se	67
6	Neem Ke Ped Ke Neeche	44	23	Ek Galti	68
7	Aakhri Ped	46	23	Sab Theek	69
8	Der Se Pahucho, Par Poora Pahucho	48	24	Bees Saal Baad	70
9	Board Exam Ke Baad	50	24	Pote	71
10	Nayi Gali	51	25	Last Part - Ant	72
11	Wapas Usi Bench Pe	52	26	Ek Aakhri Part - 22 Ped Nahi,	73
12	Aakhri Diary Entry	53	25		
13	Epilogue: Jo Naam Reh Gaye The	54	27	20 Years Later	74
14	Usi Gali Se	55	28	City Se State Tak	75
15	16 Ped Ke Baad	57	28	50 Members	76
16	Full Reunion, 8th C	58	29	Rasta Khula	77
17	Naya Villain	60	30	The Real Last - Hamesha Ke Liye Khatam	78

Volume 1 ka Naqsha

PARTS 1 TO 30 · INTRODUCTION

1-5 Shortcut

Patna ke ek chhote se park me 5 dost - Chintu, Veer, Sujoy, Ajeya, Aditya. School se ghar jaane ka shortcut park ke beech se tha. Ek din wahan ek ped achanak hilne laga. Zameen me ek chhota sa hole - Plot Hole.

6-10 Pehla Ped

Plot hole ne Sujoy ko kheench liya. Agli subah wahan ek naya ped ug aaya. Sabko laga normal hai, par Veer ko samajh aaya - Sujoy ab ped ban gaya hai, gate banke rasta rok raha hai. Dost ek karke gate bante gaye.

11-18 Gang Badhti Hai

Himanshu, Anuraag, Sameer, Ansh jaise naye ladke jude. Gang 6 se 15, 15 se 25 ho gayi. Har park me ek naya hole, har hole ke liye ek dost ko ped banna pada. Aarav diary likhta tha - har ped ka naam, har dost ki aakhri baat.

19-25 City Se State

20 saal beet gaye. Chintu 50 saal ka. Park sirf Patna me nahi, pure Bihar me faile the. Chhote chhote hole har jile me. Tab 50 members ki team bani. Sabko super natural powers mili - Koi zameen rok de, koi future dekh le, koi khud gate ban jaye. Attitude wahi - "Lambe se jayenge, shortcut nahi lenge."

26-29 Rasta Khula

Jab laga jeet gaye, tabhi beech wala ped - Sujoy wala - khula. Andar dekha toh khali. Sujoy,

Ajeya jaise purane dost thak ke chale gaye the. Unki jagah Chintu ke 4 naye doston ko khada hona pada.

30 Hamesha Ke Liye Khatam

Chintu ko samajh aaya, gate badalte rehne se kahani khatam nahi hogi. Sabko apni power chhodni hogi. 50 members ne ek saath haath rakha. Saare 25 ped ek saath gir gaye. Plot hole ki jagah ek saaf talab ban gaya. Shortcut ab safe tha. Hamesha ke liye.

Volume 1 Khatam. Tagline - Kisi ko lambe raste chalna pada, tabhi kisi aur ko seedha rasta mila.



VOLUME ONE

Ped Wala Park

पेड वाला पार्क

Chapters 1 – 30 · “Lambe se jayenge, shortcut nahi lenge.”

अध्याय १ 1

Shortcut



Gandhi Park. Patna. Ek gate tha. Jo kabhi band nahi hota tha. Chintu bola tha, "Bhai lambe se challenge." Hum hase the. 50 members. Har shaam yahin se. Par us din hawa alag thi.

अध्याय २ 2

Afwaah



Mohalle ki aunty boli, "Wahan bachche gayab ho rahe hain." Humne bola, "Aunty kaam karo."

Par us raat, Sujoy ghar nahi aaya.

अध्याय ३ 3

Pehla Ped



Subah park gaye. Ek naya ped tha. Bilkul bench ke paas. Jahan kal kuch nahi tha. Aur us ped ke neeche, Sujoy ke shoes. White wale. Naye wale.

अध्याय ४ 4

Ginti



Ajeya ne gina. Park me 25 ped. Mohalle se 25 ladke gayab. Coincidence? Nahi. Chintu chup tha. Pehli baar.

अध्याय ५ 5

Rule



Chintu bola, "Aaj se rule hai. Koi akele cross nahi karega. Koi shortcut nahi lega." Sabne haan bola. Par andar se sabko dar tha.

अध्याय ६ 6

Veer



Veer aage aaya. Bola, "Tu ja Chintu, Main rokta hu." Usne shortcut pe pair rakha. Aur hawa tez ho gayi. Agli subah, Wahan 26 ped the.

अध्याय ७ 7

Hawa



Raat ko 2 baje. Chintu ko neend nahi aayi. Park se aawaz aayi. "Soye nahi Chintu?" Sujoy ki aawaz thi. Ped se.

अध्याय ८ 8

Taweez



Sujoy ki maa aayi. Roi. Ek taweez ped pe bandha. Us raat, Sujoy ek ghante ke liye wapas aaya.

Bola, "Maa, hum gate bane hain. Raste ko rok rahe hain." Fir ped ban gaya.

अध्याय ९ 9

13th Bench



Park me 12 bench hain. Sab baithte hain. Par 13th bench pe koi nahi. Chintu baitha. Aur usko dikha, Bench ke peeche ek talab. Jo map pe nahi tha.

अध्याय १० 10

Samjha



Ajeya chillaya, "Samjha! Ye ped gate hain! Ye talab ko rok rahe hain! Talab kheech raha hai!"

Talab. Jo sabko shortcut se kheechta tha.

अध्याय ११ 11

Teacher



Science sir bole, "Beta ye koi ped nahi hai. Iski jad zameen me nahi, Kahin aur hai." Kahan?

Talab me.

अध्याय १२ 12

Diary



Veer ki diary mili. Usme likha tha, "1. Sujoy - 3rd Jan 2. Aman - 5th Jan ... 26. Veer - Aaj" Aur aakhri line, "Ab Chintu ki baari nahi aane dunga."

अध्याय १३-२० 13 - 20

Ek Ek Karke



A man bola - Tu ja, main hu. 14. Rahul bola - Arey ja na. 15. Aditya hassa aur ped ban gaya. 16.

Harsh roya nahi. 17. Faiz ne haath pakda tha. 18. Har chapter me ek kam. 19. Har ped pe ek naam. 20. Ab sirf 10 bache the. Har baar same line, "Lambe se jaana."

अध्याय २१ 21

Khali Park



Park ab bhara hua tha. 50 ped nahi, 40 ped. Aur 10 ladke. Khade. Shortcut ka rasta ab band tha. Pedon ne body se rok diya tha.

अध्याय २२ 22

Talab Bula Raha Hai



Raat ko talab se aawaz aayi. "Aao..." Chintu ko samjha, Talab ko 50 chahiye the. Pure 50.

अध्याय २३ 23

Plan



10 bache. Plan simple tha, Ek saath bhaago. Lambe se. Par talab tez tha.

अध्याय २४ 24

Dhokha



Rohit dara. Bola, "Main shortcut se bhaagta hu, fast hoga." Hum chillaye. Agli subah, 41 ped.

अध्याय २५ 25

6 Bache



6 bache. Chintu, Ajeya, aur 4. Chintu roya. Pehli baar. Bola, "Yaar khatam kaise hoga ye?"

अध्याय २६ 26

Veer Wapas



Us raat Veer wapas aaya. Ped se. Bola, "Chintu, gate banna haar nahi hai. Gate banna pyaar hai." Aur gale laga.

अध्याय २७ 27

Aakhri Gate



Subah. Chintu akela khada tha. Shortcut ke saamne. Bola, "Ab koi shortcut nahi lega. Main khada hu." Aur usne pair rakha.

अध्याय २८ 28

Subah



Subah park khali tha. Koi ladka nahi. 50 ped. Hawa chal rahi thi. Par sukoon wali. Shortcut band tha. Lambe se rasta khula tha.

अध्याय २९ 29

Naya Ladka



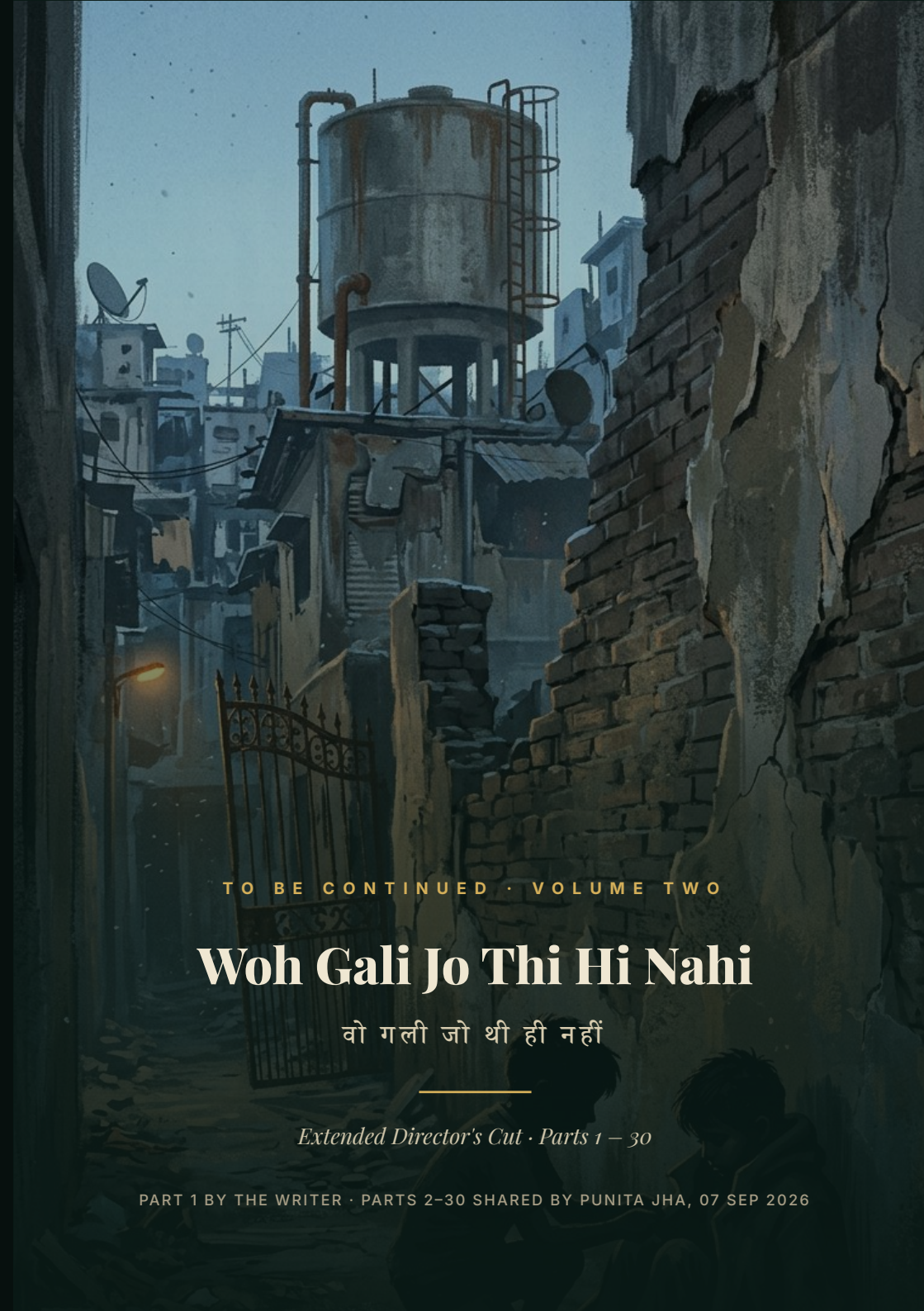
Ek chhota ladka aaya. School bag. Shortcut lene laga. Pedon ne hawa se roka. Ek tehni giri, rasta band. Ladka samjha, Aur lambe se chala gaya. Safe.

अध्याय ३० 30

Reflection



Aakhri chapter. Chintu talab pe gaya. Paani me dekha. 50 reflection. 50 hass rahe the. Sujoy bola, "Park safe hai Chintu." Veer bola, "Ab neeche chal. Asli kahani wahan hai." Paani hil gaya.



TO BE CONTINUED · VOLUME TWO

Woh Gali Jo Thi Hi Nahi

वो गली जो थी ही नहीं

Extended Director's Cut · Parts 1 – 30

PART 1 BY THE WRITER · PARTS 2-30 SHARED BY PUNITA JHA, 07 SEP 2026

PART 1 · EXTENDED DIRECTOR'S CUT

Woh Gali Jo Thi Hi Nahi

Main Ansh. Class 8th, DAV Patna, Boring Road wala nahi, jo naya wala hai us taraf ka.

Tu agar DAV me padha hai toh tujhe pata hoga last period games ka matlab kya hota hai.

Matlab hota hai May ki garmi me maut. Ground itna garam hota hai ki hawai chappal pehen ke bhaago toh chappal pighal jaye.

Us din PT wale Mishra sir ka mood pehle se kharab tha. Reason subah hi pata chal gaya tha.

9th ke do ladke ground ke peeche jo purani lab hai, uske peeche sutta maarte hue pakde gaye the. Principal ne unko toh kuch nahi bola, seedha Mishra sir ko bol diya ki discipline kharab hai. Toh gussa hum par nikla.

Poori 8th C ko. Chaar round. Bina ruke. 44 degree me. Aur jo rukega usko ek aur round.

Main second round tak theek tha. Teesre round me meri aankhon ke saamne kaala aane laga.

Chauthe round me jab main finish line pe gira toh meri t-shirt peeth se chipak gayi thi. Aisa lag raha tha kisi ne garam paani daal diya ho upar se. Saans aise aa rahi thi jaise muh me ret bhara ho. Pani ki bottle jo subah mummy ne di thi, woh kab ki khaali thi. Ek boond bhi nahi.

Mishra sir chillaye - "Chalo bhago yahan se, kal se jo homework nahi laya uska 8 round."

Hum sab apna bag ghasit-te hue nikle. Koi baat nahi kar raha tha. Sabka chehra laal.

School ki ghanti 3:20 pe baji thi. Main hamesha short-cut se jata hoon. Humari taraf ke sab bachche wahi se jaate hain. Purani paani ki tanki ke peeche wali gali. Do aadhi bani hui buildings ke beech se. Ek building ka toh pillar hi aadha bana hai, sariya bahar nikla hua hai.

Dusri ka plaster bhi nahi hua hai. Beech me itni si jagah hai ki do cycle ek saath nahi nikal sakti. Map pe woh gali hai hi nahi. Nagar nigam ke map pe nahi hai, Google pe nahi hai. Par humare liye woh main road hai. Das minute bachte hain. Aur mummy ko lagta hai main main road se aata hoon.

Wahan hamesha ek ajeeb smell aati hai. Cement ki, kachre ki, aur kabhi kabhi jali hui plastic ki.

Jaise koi subah me kachra jalata ho. Aur wahan hamesha thandak rehti hai, chahe May ho.

Kyunki dhoop seedha andar nahi aati.

Us din main bag ghasit-te hue ja raha tha. Earphone kaan me tha par phone ki battery 1% pe mar gayi thi, kuch baj nahi raha tha. Bas aadat ke liye laga rakha tha taaki koi bulaye toh sunne ka naatank kar saku.

Aur tabhi maine usse dekha.

Sujoy.

Woh tooti hui boundary wall par baitha tha. Ghutno ko seene se lagaye hue. Uski DAV ki white shirt collar se phati hui thi. Ek taraf se latak rahi thi. Uske hont ke corner se khoon aa raha tha, sukh gaya tha, kaala pad gaya tha. Uska bag zameen par khula pada tha, kitaabein keechad me bikhri hui. Science ki notebook khuli padi thi, uspar keechad laga tha. Geometry box khula tha, compass kaanta bahar nikla hua, jaise kisi ne pair se maar diya ho.

Sujoy rone wala ladka nahi hai. Tu samajh raha hai? Woh woh ladka hai jo maths me zero aane pe bhi has deta hai. Jisko Mishra sir chalk phenk ke maare toh woh catch karke wapas de de aur bole thank you sir. Woh nahi rota. Kabhi nahi.

Main bhaaga uske paas. Bag phenk diya.

"Kisne kiya be? Kaun tha? Tanki wale ladke the kya?" meri awaaz me gussa tha. Mujhe laga wahi local ladke honge jo wahan ganja peete hain.

Usne meri taraf dekha. Aur uski aankhein dekh ke mera gussa ek second me thand me badal gaya.

Aankhein laal thi, par rone wali laal nahi. Aise jaise usne bahut der tak bina palke jhapkaye kuch dekha ho. Pupils bade hue the. Itne bade ki kaali putli ne poori aankh gher li thi. Aur uski saans bahut tez thi, par awaaz nahi nikal rahi thi.

"Woh... humare school ke nahi the," woh fufusaya. Uski awaaz toot rahi thi, jaise gala sukh gaya ho. "Teen log the Ansh. Bade. Bahut bade."

Mujhe laga local ladke honge.

"Kuch leke gaye kya? Paisa tha tere paas? Phone?"

Usne naa me sir hilaya. Phir usne meri kalaai pakad li.

Aur uska haath... kasam se bol raha hoon, uska haath May ki garmi me bilkul barf jaisa thanda tha. Geela nahi, barf. Jaise freezer se nikala ho. Meri kalaai ek second me jal gayi thand se.

Maine jhatke se haath chhoda.

"Ansh, woh chal ke nahi gaye. Woh... mud gaye."

"Kya matlab mud gaye? Kahan mud gaye?"

"Woh deewar me mud gaye. Jaise... jaise kaagaz mudta hai na? Aise mod ke andar chale gaye.

Maa kasam bol raha hoon Ansh, main jhooth nahi bol raha. Ek ne mujhse time pucha. Maine bola 3:27. Phir ek bola - 'tera time khatam ho gaya'. Aur uske baad usne meri shirt kheench li.

Aur uski ungliyan... uski ungliyan meri skin ke andar ja rahi thi jaise kapde me jaati hai."

Mujhe laga shock me hai. Zyada maar diya hai toh brain hil gaya hai. Main class 8 me hoon, mujhe itna pata hai ki jab bahut maar lagti hai toh log ajeeb baatein karte hain.

Maine bola, "Chal chod, uth. Kitaabein uthate hain. Ghar chal."

Maine uski kitaabein uthani shuru ki. Ek notebook thi, science wali. Uspar ek ajeeb nishaan tha. Ek perfect geela gol circle. Bilkul perfect gol, jaise compass se banaya ho. Jaise kisi ne thanda glass rakha ho aur uska paani ka nishaan ban gaya ho. Par woh circle halki halki bhin- bhina raha tha. Awaaz nahi, vibration. Agar tu apna kaan bahut paas le jaye toh halki si bheen bheen. Jaise koi fridge chal raha ho andar.

Maine ungli se touch kiya. Thanda tha. Itna thanda ki ungli ek second me sunn ho gayi. Jaise current maar diya ho.

"Tu ghar ja Sujoy. Main call karta hoon raat ko. Apni mummy ko bolna gir gaya tha."

Woh uth ke chala gaya. Ladkhadate hue. Par har 4 kadam pe us deewar ki taraf mud ke dekh raha tha. Jaise confirm kar raha ho ki deewar wahi hai, hil toh nahi rahi.

Mujhe bhi ghar chala jaana chahiye tha. Main thaka hua tha, mera sir dard kar raha tha, mujhe ulti jaisa lag raha tha. Par us geele circle me kuch gadbad thi. Woh dhoop me sukh nahi raha tha. Dekh, May ki 3:30 ki dhoop

me Patna me paani ek minute me sukh jaata hai. Zameen garam tawa jaisi hoti hai. Woh circle waisa ka waisa tha. Geela ka geela.

Aur woh deewar jahan usne kaha tha woh mude the - uspar parchaayi nahi pad rahi thi.

Dekh, 3:30 baje har cheez ki parchaayi hoti hai. Tanki ki, building ki, meri bhi, kutte ki bhi. Uss deewar ke ek hisse par, lagbhag 6 foot chauda patch, uspar koi parchaayi nahi thi. Dhoop seedha pad rahi thi par shadow missing tha. Jaise kisi ne Photoshop me eraser se mita diya ho. Ekdam saaf patch.

Mera pet ekdum ajeeb sa hua. Jaise lift tez neeche aaye toh hota hai.

Main ghar bhaaga. Bag phenka, bottle se hi seedha paani pi gaya bina glass ke. Mummy boli khana kha le. Maine bola baad me.

Aur group call kar diya. Conference.

Humara squad - Anuraag, Aditya, Ajeya, Himanshu, Kavya aur main. Humara hamesha wala investigation squad. Hum pichhle saal se saath hain. Lunch kisne churaya se leke second floor wale boys bathroom me sach me bhoot hai ya nahi tak, sab hum investigate karte the.

Ek baar humne library se kitaab chori ka pata bhi lagaya tha.

"Sujoy ko tanki wali gali me peeta gaya hai. Woh kuch ajeeb baatein kar raha tha. Abhi aao.

Jaldi. Wahi gali me," maine bola. Meri saans abhi bhi tez thi.

"Kitne log the? Ladai karni hai kya? Main stump leke aau?" Anuraag bola. Uska toh khoon hamesha garam rehta hai. Uske papa army me hain.

"Pata nahi. Torch leke aana. Aur jo mile dande leke aana."

Das minute me hum gali ke muhane par mil gaye. Sab haanf rahe the. Sabke kapde paseene se geele. Kavya hi akeli thi jo dimaag leke aayi thi. Usne bola, "Kisi bade ko bataya? Sujoy ke ghar pe bataya?"

"Nahi. Woh bolenge wahan mat jao, khatam baat. Aur gali band kara denge. Pehle dekhthe hain," maine bola.

Gali hamesha se zyada shaant thi. Normally wahan 3-4 kutte hote hain jo har kisi pe bhaunkte hain. Aaj ek bhi nahi. Koi bike ki awaaz nahi. Koi bachcha nahi. Jaise gali ne saans rok rakhi ho. Hawa bhi nahi chal rahi thi.

Hum uss jagah par gaye. Woh geela circle jahan Sujoy ki kitaab giri thi, abhi bhi wahan tha.

Par ab woh ek nahi, teen ho gaye the. Ek perfect triangle me. Har ek same size ka. Teenon ka size bilkul same, jaise kisi machine se banaya ho. Aur teeno halke halke bhin-bhina rahe the.

Ek saath. Teeno se ek hi frequency.

"Yeh paani nahi hai," Aditya ne bola. Woh sabse pehle jhuka. Woh sabse hoshiyar hai. Usne ungli se chhoo liya. Usne jhatke se haath peeche kheench liya. "Maa kasam barf jaisa thanda hai. Par geela nahi hai. Haath geela nahi hua. Dekh."

Uska haath sukha tha.

Himanshu ne, Himanshu hone ke naate, apna cricket ka stump jo woh hamesha carry karta hai, bag me rakhta hai, liya aur uss bina parchaayi wali deewar ko pok kiya. Himanshu ko lagta hai stump se har problem solve hoti hai.

Stump andar chala gaya.

Jaise eent toot gayi ho waise nahi. Jaise deewar makkhan ho aur stump garam chaku ho.

Bas... andar chala gaya. Smooth. Par side se dekho toh deewar solid lag rahi thi. Eentein dikh rahi thi, cement dikh raha tha. Par stump andar tha. Adha bahar, adha andar.

Hum sab chup ho gaye. Ek dum pin drop silence. Kavya ka haath kaapne laga.

"Ansh," Ajeya fufusayi. Woh sci-fi ki deewani hai, usne Interstellar 4 baar dekhi hai, usko sab pata hai. "Tera haath dekh. Aur hawa dekh."

Deewar ke aas-paas ki hawa kaamp rahi thi. Jaise garmi me sadak pe hawa hilti hai. Mirage jaisa. Par wahan garmi nahi thi, thand thi. Hawa kaap rahi thi.

Tabhi hume rone ki awaaz aayi. Deewar ke ANDAR se.

Woh Sujoy ki awaaz thi. Bilkul clear.

"Help... Ansh... unhone mujhe wapas kheench liya... help karo... mujhe yahan se nikalo..."

Himanshu chillaya, "Sujoy! Tu kahan hai! Humne toh tujhe das minute pehle chhoda tha! Tu ghar nahi gaya kya! Tu andar kaise?"

Maine kaapte haath se Sujoy ko call kiya. Switch off nahi tha. Ring ja rahi thi.

Tring... tring...

Ringtone deewar ke andar se aa rahi thi. Deewar ke uss bina shadow wale patch ke andar se.

Kavya ke muh se cheekh nikal gayi par usne apne muh ko dono haathon se band kar liya.

Aditya ne apni phone ki flashlight jalayi aur uss kaampte hue dhundh me maari. Usne light andar maari.

Aur ek second ke liye, hume eentein nahi dikhi. Ek corridor dikha. Lamba, safed, jiska koi ant nahi tha. Hospital ke corridor jaisa, par light bina source ke aa rahi thi. Na bulb, na tube, bas light thi. Aur wahan aakritiyan khadi thi. Lambi, patli. 7-8 foot lambi. Unki chamdi sikude hue kaagaz jaisi thi, jo insaan banne ki koshish kar rahi ho par abhi tak seekh rahi ho. Unke ghutne ulta mud rahe the. Jaise toota hua mannequin ho. Aur beech me, Sujoy, kisi invisible cheez par mukke maar raha tha, ro raha tha. Usko koi pakad ke rakha tha.

Ek kaagaz-aadmi mud ke dekha. Uska chehra blank tha, par uski chhaati par Sujoy ki phati hui shirt jaisa design tha, jaise usne copy kiya ho aur galat bana diya ho. Collar ulta tha, button galat jagah pe.

Woh bullying nahi thi. Woh... usse pehenne ki koshish thi. Uska shape seekhne ki. Jaise hum kapda pehente hain waise woh logon ko pehente hain.

"Bhaago," maine kaha. Meri awaaz nikal hi nahi rahi thi. Gala sukh gaya tha.

Par zameen par bane triangle wale circle jal uthe. Neeli roshni se. Dheemi bhin-bhinahat tez goonj me badal gayi. Hawa bhaari ho gayi, jaise toofan se pehle hoti hai. Kaan band hone lage, jaise plane me hota hai.

Corridor kheenchne laga. Mere bag ka strap deewar ki taraf kheench raha tha. Dhool, patte, chhote patthar sab usmein slide ho raha tha, deewar ke andar. Jaise koi vacuum ho andar.

"Yeh ek fold hai!" Ajeya achanak boli, uski aankhein badi ho gayi, usko samajh aa gaya. "Jaise space fold hota hai! Wormhole! Ek short-cut! Woh space ko modte hain! Sujoy ka yahi matlab tha ki woh mud gaye! Woh chal ke nahi gaye, unhone space ko mod diya! Isiliye shadow nahi hai! Kyunki light bhi mud rahi hai!"

Kaagaz-aadmi paas aa rahe the. Unka chalna galat tha - unke ghutne peeche ki taraf mud rahe the, kat kat kat ki awaaz aa rahi thi. Jaise lakdi toot rahi ho.

Anuraag ne sabse stupid, sabse bahadur kaam kiya jo aaj tak kisi ne kiya hoga. Usne apna stump liya aur beech wale circle par poori taakat se maara. Bina soche.

DHAD!

Light flicker karne lagi. Jaise tubelight kharab ho toh karti hai.

Goonj cheekhne lagi. Aisi cheekh jo kaan se nahi, daanton me feel hoti hai. Jaise koi chalk ko board pe ragad de.

Ek second ke liye, sab freeze ho gaya. Hume doosri taraf saaf dikha. Woh corridor nahi tha.

Woh ek maidaan tha. Ek khula, safed maidaan jisme aise hi folds bhare hue the - saikdon khuli deewarein, har ek alag gali me, alag sheher me, alag desh me khul rahi thi. Ek station.

Junction. Aur un jaise jeev duniyon ke beech ghoom rahe the, ghol-mil jaane ke liye logon ko kapdon ki tarah pehen rahe the.

Aur humne darjanon aur bachche dekhe. Kuch DAV uniform me. Kuch dusre school ke. Kuch toh bade aadmi bhi. Amber me phase keede jaise folds ke beech me trapped, hawa me latke hue. Zinda, par hil nahi rahe.

Sujoy sabse paas tha. Uska haath bilkul kuch inch door tha. Bas haath.

Maine uska haath pakda. Woh bilkul barf tha. Jaise mar chuka ho. Jaise koi murda ho.

Maine kheencha. Anuraag ne mujhe pakda, Aditya ne usse, Ajeya ne Aditya ko, Kavya ne

Himanshu ko, Himanshu ne Anuraag ko. Human chain. Jaise kabaddi me pakadte hain.

Humne poori taakat se kheencha. Meri chappal nikal gayi.

Tape ke phatne jaisi awaaz aayi. CHARR! Jaise koi fevicol wala tape kheench ke phaat rahe ho.

Sujoy bahar aa gaya. Woh asli cement wali gali me gir gaya, haanf raha tha, ab sach me ro raha tha. Garam aansu. Pehli baar uski aankh se garam paani nikla, thanda nahi.

Uske peeche, corridor collapse hone laga. Kaagaz-aadmi cheekhe - awaaz nahi, daanton me ek current jaisi, jaise bijli ka jhatka.

Deewar wapas snap ho gayi. Solid. Is baar parchaayi ke saath. Poori parchaayi wapas.

Zameen par bane circle hiss ki awaaz ke saath sukh gaye, triangle ke shape ka jala hua nishaan chhod gaye. Jaise cigarette se jala ho. Kaala nishaan.

Khatam ho gaya tha. Kutte phir se bhaunkne lage. Ek bike guzri, uska horn baja. Jaise kuch hua hi na ho. Ek aurat kachra phenk ke gayi.

Sujoy kaamp raha tha. Usne kaha, "Woh thake hue logon ko le jaate hain. Woh bole... thaka hua dimaag dheela hota hai. Modna aasaan hota hai."

Humne school me kisi ko poori kahani nahi batayi. Kaun vishwas karta? Humne teacher se bola Sujoy gir gaya tha, usko chakkar aa gaya, garmi se.

Par hum chhe - hum ab woh short-cut nahi lete. Kabhi nahi jaatee

... Part 2 ka aage ka wahi se ...

Us raat main ghar aake soya nahi. Haath abhi bhi thanda tha. Jahan Sujoy ne pakda tha wahan ek safed nishaan ban gaya tha, gol. Maa ne bola machhar ne kaata hai, par woh machhar ka nishaan nahi tha. Woh bilkul perfect gol tha.

Sujoy ka raat ko 1 baje message aaya.

"Bhai soya kya? Meri deewar me se awaaz aa rahi hai. Jaise koi kharoch raha ho andar se."

Main turant uske ghar gaya. Cycle se. Uski gali me kutte bhaunk rahe the. Uske ghar ka darwaza khula tha. Uski mummy pareshan khadi thi.

"Subah se kuch kha nahi raha. Bol raha hai deewar hil rahi hai. Bukhaar bhi nahi hai. Par kamre me thand bahut hai."

Main uske kamre me gaya. Sujoy bed par baitha tha, wahi position me - ghutne seene se lagaye. Poora paseene me. Aur uske saamne wali deewar pe ek patch tha. 6 foot ka. Wahan parchaayi nahi thi. AC band tha, phir bhi us patch ke aas paas ka curtain hil raha tha, us patch ki taraf khinch raha tha. Jaise us patch me hawa andar ja rahi ho.

Zameen pe ek geela circle banta hua tha. Dheere dheere. Jaise invisible balti se paani gir raha ho, par paani dikh nahi raha. Sirf geelapan aa raha tha. Aur uski bhin-bhinahat phir se shuru.

Sujoy fufusaya - "Woh bol rahe hain maine unka gate toda, ab mujhe hi gate banna padega.

Woh mera shape pehenna chahte hain. Permanent."

Maine sabko call kiya. Aditya, Anuraag, Ajeya, Himanshu, Kavya. Sab aadhi raat ko aaye. Sujoy ki mummy ne bola kya hua hai. Kavya ne bola - "Aunty, isko thoda fever hai, hum isko chhat pe le ja rahe hain, hawa me theek lagega."

Chhat pe le gaye. Sabse khuli jagah. Wahan koi deewar nahi thi jisme fold khul sake. Sirf aasman.

Beech me balti rakhi. Namak wala paani. Sujoy ki dadi ne di hui agarbatti. 5 agarbatti.

Sujoy ne apni wohi notebook nikali jispe pehla circle bana tha. Woh abhi bhi thandi thi.

Beech me rakhi. Agarbatti jalayi.

Pehle ek minute sab normal. Dhuaan seedha upar.

Phir dhuaan tedha hone laga. Saara dhuaan us notebook ki taraf mudne laga. Jaise notebook saans le rahi ho. Notebook ka safed circle geela hone laga. Wapas. Neela hone laga.

Himanshu ne mitti ka tel daala aur aag lagayi.

Aag lagi par kaagaz kaala nahi hua. Aag neeli ho gayi. Thandi aag. Paas jao toh thand lagti thi.

Aur us neeli aag me se awaazein aane lagi. Bahut saare bachchon ke rone ki. Ek saath. Jaise koi classroom ho jisme sab ro rahe ho.

Aditya ne poori balti us neeli aag pe palat di.

Awaaz aayi - CHHHHHHHHEEEENNNN - jaise garam lohe pe paani gira ho.

Neeli aag phati. Ek flash. Aur us flash me hum chhat pe nahi the. Hum us maidaan me the.

Safed maidaan. Jisme hazaron deewarein khuli hui thi. Har deewar ek alag jagah pe khul rahi thi. Koi Patna ki gali me, koi Delhi ke metro station me, koi kisi school ke bathroom me. Aur har deewar ke saamne ek bachcha latka

hua tha. Hawa me. Amber me keeda jaise. Kuch DAV uniform me, kuch dusre school ke. Sabki aankhein band thi.

Aur beech me woh khada tha. Lamba wala. 10 foot ka. Is baar usne koi uniform nahi pehna tha. Blank tha. Uska chehra abhi bhi ban raha tha. Kabhi Sujoy jaisa, kabhi mera jaisa.

Usne Sujoy ki taraf haath badhaya. Sujoy ka haath barf jaisa hone laga. Neela padne laga.

Maine uska haath pakda. Anuraag ne mera. Chain bana liya. Kavya ne apni torch us blank chehre pe maari.

Us torch ki roshni se uska chehra jalne laga. Kaagaz jaise jalne laga. Woh cheekha. Awaaz kaan se nahi, daanton me baji.

Notebook ki raakh se ek tez hawa nikli aur usko andar kheench liya. Jaise vacuum cleaner ne kaagaz ko kheench liya ho. Woh sikudta hua, mudta hua andar chala gaya.

Sab shaant. Dhuaan seedha upar. Balti me sirf kaali raakh. Aur us raakh me ek triangle ka nishaan.

Sujoy hosh me aaya. Uska haath garam tha. Pehli baar uska haath garam tha us din ke baad.

Neeche aaye toh uske kamre ki deewar pe parchaayi wapas aa gayi thi. Geela circle sukh gaya tha. Sirf ek jala hua triangle ka nishaan bacha tha. Humne uspe uska time-table chipka diya.

Agle hafte Nagar Nigam wale aaye. Dono aadhi bani buildings pe notice chipka diya - ILLEGAL

CONSTRUCTION. TO BE DEMOLISHED. Ek hafte me JCB aayi aur dono tod di. Ab wahan khula maidaan hai. Dhoop hi dhoop. Koi shadow ka patch nahi. Hum wahi se jaate hain ab.

Par kahani wahan khatam nahi hui.

Do din baad hum second floor wale bathroom me gaye. Jahan hamesha kehte hain bhoot hai.

Wahan tiles pe ek naya geela circle tha. Naya. Aur ek chhota joota. Class 6 ke bachche ka.

Size bahut chhota. Aur deewar pe kharoch ke nishaan, jaise kisi ne nakhoon se kharocha ho andar jaane ke liye.

Samajh gaye, woh log jagah badal gaye hain. Gali tod di toh bathroom me aa gaye.

Humne us Class 6 ke bachche ko dhoonda. Naam tha Aman. 6th B ka. Do din se school nahi aaya tha. Uski mummy boli raat me bolta hai deewar me se koi bula raha hai.

Hum uske ghar gaye. Uske kamre me wahi patch. Bina parchaayi ka.

Us din last period games tha. Mishra sir ne phir daudaya. Hum jaan bujh ke thake, taaki woh hume dekhe. Taaki gate khule.

School khatam hone ke baad main aur Anuraag bathroom me ruke. Darwaza andar se band kiya. Tiles barf jaisi thandi.

Patch aaya. Mirror ke side wali deewar pe. Bulb flicker karne laga. Hawa kaampne lagi.

Deewar chamdi ki tarah phati. Andar se wohi maidaan dikha.

Aur beech me woh khada tha. Lamba wala. Ab uski body pe hazaron cheezein chipki hui thi.

ID cards, jootey, shirts, compass box. Jo usne saalon se pehna tha. Uska chehra aadha mera, aadha Sujoy ka, ab uspe Aman ka bhi hissa jud raha tha.

Anuraag ne lohe ka tiffin nikala. Bori bhar namak.

Maine apna jala hua ID card us geele circle me phenka. Circle neeli aag ban gaya.

Woh jhuka ID card uthane. Anuraag ne poora namak uspe palat diya. Uska kaagaz jaisi skin jalne lagi. Cheen ki awaaz.

Maine geometry ka compass uski khuli peeth me poora ghusa diya. Jahan se skin khuli hui thi.

PHUSSSSSS - gubbara phatne jaisi awaaz. Andar se hawa nahi, cheekhein nikli. Hazaron bachchon ki.

Woh tadpa. Usne apna asli roop dikhaya. Koi haddi nahi. Sirf sikuda hua kaagaz jaisa jiska shape insaan jaisa banne ki koshish kar raha tha. Aur us kaagaz pe hazaron chehre chipke hue the.

Anuraag ne uska haath pakad ke ulta mod diya, peeche ki taraf. Jaise uske ghotne mudte the.

KADAK - kaagaz phatne ki awaaz. Neeli roshni.

Maine uska doosra haath namak me ragad diya.

Woh deewar ki taraf bhaaga. Anuraag ne taang pakad ke tiles pe patak diya. Hum dono ne usko uthaya aur usi neeli aag wale circle me phenk diya. Woh jala nahi, sikuda. Polythene jaise. Chhota hota gaya. Uske andar se saare ID card, jootey, kitaabein bahar girne lage. Ek ke baad ek. Last me sirf ek chhota sa kaagaz ka tukda bacha. Anuraag ne uspar joota rakh ke masal diya. Raakh. Deewar DHAD se band hui. Par iss baar parchaayi ke saath. Solid. Zameen pe geela circle sukh gaya. Ek halki thandi hawa nikli. Us hawa me awaaz thi, jaise hazaron bachche ek saath bol rahe ho - thank you. Hum bahar nikle. Aman ka joota wahi pada tha. Humne usko uthaya aur uske ghar de aaye. Agle din Aman school aaya. Theek tha. Uske baad se us bathroom me kabhi geela circle nahi bana. Kabhi bulb flicker nahi kiya. Ab us gali ki jagah khula maidaan hai. Wahan cricket khelte hain. Wahan shadow har jagah hai. Wahan fold nahi khul sakta kyunki deewar hi nahi hai. Sujoy ab theek hai. Daudta bhi hai. Pehle se tez. Humne ek rule bana liya hai. Agar kabhi kisi deewar par parchaayi na pade, ya mirror me apni shakal ek second late aaye, ya tiles barf jaisi thandi lage May me, toh wahan se bhaag jao. Shortcut mat lo. Kabhi nahi.

PART 2 ·

Raat ko main ghar aaya toh bukhaar jaisa lag raha tha. Badan garam tha par haath thande the.

Mummy ne bola games me zyada bhaag liya hoga. Main kuch bola nahi. Sujoy ka message aaya - "So pa raha hai? Deewar abhi bhi hil rahi hai mere kamre me."

Maine turant call kiya. Usne bola uski mummy ko kuch dikh nahi raha, par usko deewar ka ek patch bina parchaayi ka dikh raha hai. Wahi 6 foot wala.

Uske kamre me AC band tha phir bhi uska curtain us patch ki taraf khinch raha tha, jaise hawa us taraf ja rahi ho.

Hum agle din school me mile. Staff room ke peeche, jahan peon beedi peeta hai. Sujoy nahi aaya tha subah assembly me. Uski aankhon ke neeche kaale ghere the.

Kavya ne apni diary nikali. Usne us din se har cheez likh rakhi thi. Date, time, jagah.

"Pattern dekho," usne bola. "Pehli baar gali me, dusri baar Sujoy ke kamre me. Matlab woh ek jagah se chipak gaye hain. Jaise keela hota hai. Notebook."

Sujoy ne apni wahi science wali notebook nikali. Jispar pehla geela circle bana tha. Ab woh sukh gaya tha par uska daag tha. Ek halka safed circle. Haath lagao toh thanda lagta tha abhi bhi.

"Yeh anchor hai," Ajeya boli. "Jaise jahaz ko rokne ke liye langar dalte hain, waise inko ek nishaan chahiye hota hai idhar rukne ke liye. Jab tak yeh nishaan rahega, woh wapas aa sakte hain. Chahe building tod do."

Aditya bola, "Toh isko khatam karna padega."

Plan bana. Chhat pe. Sujoy ke ghar ki chhat. Sabse khuli jagah. Wahan koi deewar nahi thi aas paas. Sirf aasman.

Raat ko sab chhat pe mile. Beech me ek balti rakhi. Usme namak wala paani. Sujoy ki dadi ne bola tha - jahan hawa bhaari lage, wahan namak chhidko. Buri hawa kat-ti hai.

Sujoy ne notebook beech me rakhi. Kavya ne 5 agarbatti jalayi. Charo taraf lagayi.

Hawa ekdum ruk gayi. Agarbatti ka dhuaan seedha upar ja raha tha. Normal. Ek minute tak normal.

Phir dhuaan tedha hone laga. Seedha upar jaane ke bajaye, woh notebook ki taraf mudne laga.

Jaise notebook saans le rahi ho aur dhuaan kheench rahi ho. Saara dhuaan ek point pe ja raha tha, us safed circle pe.

Notebook ka circle geela hone laga. Wapas. Bina paani ke geela. Aise jaise andar se paseena aa raha ho.

Sujoy chillaya, "Jalao! Jalao isko!"

Himanshu ne mitti ka tel daala notebook pe aur machis jalayi.

Notebook jali nahi. Aag lagi, par kaagaz kaala nahi hua. Aag neela rang ki ho gayi. Thandi aag.

Haath paas le jao toh thandi lagti thi. Aur us neeli aag me se awaazein aane lagi. Bahut saare bachchon ke rone ki. Kisi ke hasne ki. Kisi ke help maangne ki. Saari awaazein ek saath.

Anuraag bola, "Paani daalo!"

Aditya ne poori balti us neeli aag pe palat di.

CHHHHHHHHEEEENNNNNN

Itni tez awaaz aayi ki pados ke kutte ek saath bhaunkne lage. Neeli aag bujhi nahi, woh phat gayi. Jaise bulb phat-ta hai. Ek neeli flash.

Aur us phatne me se ek jhalak dikhi.

Hum chhat pe nahi the. Hum us maidaan me the. Us station me. Charo taraf hazaron deewarein khuli hui. Har deewar ek alag gali me khul rahi thi. Koi Patna me, koi Delhi me, koi kisi aur desh me. Har deewar ke saamne ek bachcha khada tha, DAV uniform me, ya dusre uniform me. Sab thake hue. Sabki aankhein band thi.

Aur beech me woh lamba paper-man. Is baar usne koi uniform nahi pehna tha. Woh khali tha.

Blank. 10 foot ka.

Usne Sujoy ki taraf dekha.

Sujoy ka haath phir se barf jaisa thanda hone laga. Uski aankhein peeche jaane lagi. Woh girne laga.

Maine uska haath pakda. "Nahi! Sujoy ko nahi le jaoge!"

Kavya ne apni torch nikali aur full tez karke us patch pe maari jahan se dhuaan aa raha tha.

Notebook ki raakh se ek hawa nikli aur us paper-man ko andar kheench liya. Jaise vacuum cleaner ne kaagaz ko kheench liya ho. Woh sikudta hua andar chala gaya.

Sab shaant ho gaya. Dhuaan seedha upar jaane laga. Balti me sirf kaali raakh thi. Notebook poori jal chuki thi.

Sujoy hosh me aaya. Uska haath garam tha. Pehli baar us raat uska haath garam tha.

Agli subah hum maidaan me gaye. Jahan pehle gali thi, wahan ab sirf khali jagah thi. Nagar

Nigam wale aaye the. Notice chipka diya tha - ILLEGAL CONSTRUCTION. TO BE DEMOLISHED.

Sujoy bola, "Ab woh mujhe anchor nahi bana sakte. Par maine us station me ek cheez dekhi."

"Matlab?"

"Jab main andar tha, maine aur bachche dekhe the. Ek bachcha toh 2019 ke DAV uniform me tha. Matlab woh 7 saal se wahan trapped hai. Usne mujhe bola, yeh station hai. Yeh log traveller hain. Woh duniya se duniya jaate hain. Aur har duniya me woh ek naya shortcut banate hain. Ek fold."

Kavya boli, "Toh shortcut lena hi problem hai?"

Sujoy bola, "Shortcut lena problem nahi hai. Thak ke shortcut lena problem hai. Kyunki tab tu dhyaan nahi deta. Aur wahi mauka woh lete hain."

Ek hafte tak sab shaant raha. Koi photo nahi, koi geela circle nahi.

Phir ek din hum second floor wale bathroom gaye. Lunch break me. Wahan jahan hamesha kehte hain bhoot hai.

Wahan tiles pe ek naya geela circle tha. Aur ek chhota joota. Class 6 ke bachche ka. Aur andar se khin-khin ki awaaz.

Anuraag bola, "Wapas aa gaye. Nayi jagah."

Woh Class 6 wale ka joota dekh ke samajh aa gaya ki woh log jagah badal gaye hain. Gali tod di toh bathroom me aa gaye.

Last period games tha. Phir se. Mishra sir ne phir daudaya. Hum jaan bujh ke thake. Kyunki thake hue ko hi woh dikhta hai. Humko usko bulana tha.

School khatam. Sab chale gaye. Hum dono - main aur Anuraag - second floor bathroom me ghus gaye. Akela. Darwaza band.

Tiles thandi thi. May me bhi thandi. Bahar 44 degree, andar barf jaisa.

Woh patch aaya. Mirror ke side wali deewar pe. Bina shadow ka. Hawa kaampne lagi. Bulb flicker karne laga.

Aur deewar phati. Kaagaz ki tarah nahi, chamdi ki tarah. Andar se wohi maidaan dikha.

Aur beech me woh khada tha. Lamba wala. Jiski body pe hazaron cheezein chipki hui thi. DAV ke ID cards, jootey, shirts, compass box, sab kuch jo usne

saalon se chura ke pehna tha. Uska chehra ab blank nahi tha. Uspe mera chehra aadha bana hua tha, aur aadha Sujoy ka. Galat joda hua. Jaise do photo ko kaat ke chipkaya ho.

Usne mujhe dekha.

Anuraag ne peeche se darwaza lock kar diya. Aur apne bag se cheez nikali. Lohe ka tiffin box.

Aur usme namak. Bori bhar ke. Jo hum mess se laye the.

Maine apna ID card nikala, jala hua wala, aur us geele circle me phenk diya. Circle jalne laga.

Entity chillayi. Aisi cheekh jo kaan se nahi, haddi me bajti hai. Woh jhuka apna ID card uthane.

Aur Anuraag ne poora namak ka bora uske upar palat diya. Aur uske khule hue peeth pe, jahan se uska kaagaz jaisa chamda khula tha, wahan maine apna geometry ka compass poora ghusa diya.

Compass ka nok andar gaya toh awaaz aayi jaise gubbara phat raha ho.

PHUSSSSSSSSSS

Uske andar se hawa nahi, cheekh nikli. Saare bachchon ki. Hazaron ki.

Woh tadapne laga. Usne apna asli roop dikhaya. Koi body nahi. Sirf sikuda hua kaagaz jaisa kuch jo insaan ka shape lene ki koshish kar raha tha. Aur us kaagaz pe hazaron chehre chipke hue the. Bachchon ke. Jo saalon se gayab hue the.

Anuraag ne uska ek haath pakda. Barf jaisa. Aur uske kaagaz wale haath ko pakad ke ulta mod diya. Peeche ki taraf. Jaise uske ghutne mudte the waise.

KADAK

Kaagaz phatne ki awaaz. Neeli roshni nikli andar se.

Maine uska doosra haath pakda aur uske hi namak me ragad diya. Namak uske kaagaz ki skin ko jala raha tha. Jaise tezaab.

Woh deewar ki taraf bhaaga, apne station me wapas jaane ke liye. Par Anuraag ne uski taang pakad li aur kheench ke wapas tiles pe patak diya.

Tiles pe woh geele circle ab aag ban gaya tha. Neeli aag. Namak wali.

Hum dono ne usko uthaya aur usi aag wale circle me phenk diya.

Woh jala nahi. Woh sikuda. Jaise polythene jalti hai toh sikudti hai waise. Chhota hota gaya.

Uske andar se saare ID card, jootey, kitaabein bahar girne lage. Ek ke baad ek. Jaise koi almirah khali ho rahi ho.

Last me sirf ek chhota sa kaagaz ka tukda bacha.

Anuraag ne uspar apna joota rakha aur poori taakat se masal diya. Raakh bana diya.

Deewar ek jhatke se band hui. DHAD. Is baar parchaayi ke saath. Solid.

Zameen pe jo geela circle tha, woh sukh gaya. Aur wahan se ek halki si hawa nikli, thandi. Aur us hawa me ek awaaz thi, jaise hazaron bachche ek saath bol rahe ho - thank you.

Hum dono wahan se nikle. Poore paseene me. Haath abhi bhi barf jaise thande the.

Ab us bathroom me koi geela nishaan nahi banta. Kabhi nahi.

Ek hafte me dono buildings tod di gayi. JCB aayi, sab tod diya. Ab wahan khula maidaan hai.

Dhoop hi dhoop. Koi shadow ka patch nahi. Sab jagah dhoop.

Hum ab uss khule maidaan se jaate hain. Wahan shadow har jagah hai. Wahan fold nahi ho

sakta kyunki wahan deewar hi nahi hai.

Sujoy ab theek hai. Woh ab games period me daudta bhi hai. Pehle se zyada tez.

Par ek rule bana diya hai humne. Second floor ke bathroom me agar kabhi bulb flicker kare, ya mirror me apni parchaayi ek second late aaye, ya kisi deewar par shadow na pade, toh hum wahan se bhaag jaate hain. Shortcut nahi lete.

Kabhi nahi lete.

PART 3 ·

Us bathroom wale din ke baad laga khatam ho gaya. Par Sujoy theek nahi hua tha. Uske haath pe jo triangle ka nishaan tha, woh safed se halka neela padne laga tha. Raat ko usko sapne aate the. Woh bolta tha maidaan me abhi bhi bachche latke hue hain. Jo 2019 wale hain, 2021 wale hain. Unko koi nikalne nahi aaya.

Kavya ne bola - "Humne sirf ek gate band kiya hai. Station abhi bhi hai. Dusre gates abhi bhi khule honge."

Ajeya ne apni diary me ek map banaya. Patna ka. Uspe nishaan lagaye - tanki wali gali, second floor bathroom, library ke peeche wala kone jahan hamesha thand rehti hai, aur canteen ke peeche wali deewar jahan kabhi paint nahi tikta. Char jagah. Char jagah pe bina shadow wala patch dekha tha humne pichle ek saal me. Par dhyaan nahi diya tha.

Aditya bola - "Matlab ye charon gates ek hi station pe khulte hain. Ek ko toda toh dusra khul gaya."

Anuraag bola - "Toh chaaron ko ek saath todna padega."

Plan bana. Sunday ka. School band. Chowkidar ko pata nahi chale. Hum chaaron jagah pe ek saath namak aur agarbatti lagayenge. Ek hi waqt pe.

Char teams. Main aur Anuraag - second floor bathroom. Aditya aur Himanshu - tanki wala maidaan. Kavya aur Ajeya - library ke peeche. Sujoy akela nahi, woh canteen ke peeche wale gate pe, par uske saath uski dadi ka diya hua hanuman ka chhota locket.

Raat ke 12 baje mile. School ki boundary chhoti hai, kood ke andar ghuse. Andhera tha. Sirf emergency light jal rahi thi corridor me.

Hum apni apni jagah pe gaye. Phone pe group call on tha, mute pe, taaki ek dusre ki saans sun sake.

Kavya fufusayi - "Meri jagah pe patch aa gaya. Hawa kaamp rahi hai."

Aditya bola - "Yahan bhi geela circle ban raha hai. Triangle wala."

Mere saamne bathroom me bhi wahi. Tiles pe geela circle. Deewar pe bina shadow ka patch.

Bulb flicker.

Sujoy bola - "Mere yahan sabse bada hai. Poori deewar pe shadow nahi hai. Andar se awaazein aa rahi hain."

Maine bola - "Ab."

Charon ne ek saath apni balti ka namak wala paani us geele circle pe phenka. Aur agarbatti gaad di beech me.

Charon jagah se ek hi awaaz aayi - CHHHHHHEEN - jaise koi bahut bada cooker seeti maar raha ho.

Deewarein ek saath phati. Charon gates ek saath khule. Aur hum charon ko ek hi maidaan dikha. Safed maidaan. Par ab woh khali nahi tha. Wahan saikdon kaagaz-aadmi the. Lambi line me khade. Har ek ne kuch na kuch pehna hua tha. Kisi ne school bag, kisi ne joota, kisi ne

ID card. Aur beech me hazaron bachche hawa me latke hue. Jaise kisi ne unko pin se tang diya ho. Sabki aankhein band.

Sujoy chillaya - "Woh sabko le ja rahe hain! Ek saath!"

Us maidaan ke beech me ek bada fold tha. Sabse bada. Usme se ek bahut bada kaagaz- aadmi nikla. 15 foot ka. Uska chehra blank nahi tha, uspe hazaron chehre the, ek ke upar ek.

Jaise koi collage ho.

Usne haath badhaya toh charon gates se hawa kheenchne lagi andar ki taraf. Hamare bag, hamare jootey, sab andar khinchne lage.

Kavya ne apni diary ka panna phaada jispe usne triangle banaya tha aur usko jala diya agarbatti se. Us jalte hue panna ko usne geele circle me phenk diya.

Aditya ne apna compass nikala aur apne gate ke circle me ghusa diya. Himanshu ne hammer se maara.

Maine aur Anuraag ne apne gate pe poora namak ka bora palat diya aur compass ghusa diya.

Sujoy ne apne gale se locket nikala aur us bade wale ke saamne phenk diya. Locket uske kaagaz ke shareer pe gira toh wahan se dhuaan nikalne laga. Jaise tezaab gira ho.

Bada wala cheekha. Uski cheekh se poora maidaan hil gaya. Saare chhote kaagaz-aadmi bhi cheekhe.

Us cheekh se jo bachche latke hue the, unme se kuch ki aankhein khuli. 2019 wala ladka jo

DAV uniform me tha, usne haath hilaya.

Sujoy bola - "Kheencho unko!"

Hum charon ne apni apni jagah se haath badhaya andar maidaan me. Hawa garam se thandi ho gayi. Haath barf jaise hone lage. Par humne kheencha. Ek ko, do ko, teen ko.

Jaise hi ek bachcha bahar aata, uska gate band ho jaata - DHAD - parchaayi ke saath.

Ek ke baad ek, humne 11 bachche kheencha. Sab alag alag school ke. Sab thake hue, par zinda.

Aakhri me woh bada wala bacha tha. Usne Sujoy ka pair pakad liya. Sujoy ka pair neela padne laga.

Anuraag ne apna stump uthaya aur us bade wale ke ghutne pe, jo ulta mudta tha, poori taakat se maara.

KADAK KADAK - dono ghutne peeche ki taraf toot gaye. Kaagaz phatne ki awaaz.

Bada wala gira. Girte hi woh sikudne laga. Jaise polythene jalti hai waise. Chhota hota gaya.

15 foot se 10 foot, 10 foot se 5 foot, 5 foot se ek kaagaz ke tukde jitna.

Aditya ne us tukde pe namak phenka. Woh hiss karke raakh ban gaya.

Ek second me saare gates ek saath band hue. Charon jagah - DHAD DHAD DHAD DHAD - char awaazein. Aur har jagah parchaayi wapaa.

Hum charon apni apni jagah pe gir gaye. Paseene me. Haath barf jaise.

Subah tak hum school me hi rahe. Chowkidar ne dekha toh bola - "Tum log yahan kya kar rahe ho?" Humne bola project hai.

Us din ke baad school me kabhi kisi deewar pe bina shadow wala patch nahi dikha. Library ke peeche wala kone ab garam rehta hai. Canteen ke peeche paint tikne laga.

Nagar Nigam ne us khule maidaan me ab ek chhota park bana diya hai. Jhule lage hain. Sham ko bachche khelte hain.

Sujoy ke haath ka triangle wala nishaan ab halka ho gaya hai. Safed se ab skin ke colour ka ho gaya hai. Par abhi bhi hai. Woh kehta hai kabhi kabhi usme thand lagti hai.

Aman, jo Class 6 ka tha, ab theek hai. Woh kabhi kabhi humare saath cricket khelne aata hai usi maidaan me.

Hum ab bhi shortcut nahi lete. Kabhi nahi. Chahe kitna bhi thak jaye, lambe raste se jaate hain.

Shadow dekh ke chalte hain. Jahan shadow hai, wahan gate nahi khul sakta.

Kyunki ab pata hai, woh gali jo thi hi nahi, woh ek gali nahi thi. Woh ek soch thi. Har us jagah pe hai jahan hum thak ke kehte hain - bas jaldi pahuch jau.

Isliye hum ab kehte hain - der se pahucho, par pooraa pahucho.

PART 4 ·

Aakhri Raat

Us chaar gate wale din ke baad sabko laga khatam ho gaya. School me sab normal lag raha tha. Library ke peeche wala kone ab garam rehta tha, wahan pehle hamesha thand rehti thi.

Canteen ke peeche wali deewar pe paint tikne laga tha, pehle har mahine paint utar jaata tha.

Second floor bathroom ke tiles ab May me bhi garam rehte the.

Par Sujoy ka triangle wala nishaan abhi bhi tha. Halka ho gaya tha, par raat ko usme kabhi kabhi thand lagti thi. Woh bolta tha sapne me abhi bhi woh maidaan dikhta hai, par ab wahan bachche nahi latke, sirf khali deewarein hain. Aur beech me ek darwaza band pada hai, jiske peeche se koi kharoch raha hai.

Ek raat Sujoy ne call kiya. Bola - "Ansh, park wali jagah pe aaja. Jahan pehle gali thi. Abhi."

Raat ke 11 baj rahe the. Main cycle se gaya. Park me jhule khali pade the. Sujoy wahi bench pe baitha tha jahan pehle tanki thi. Uske haath me uski purani science wali notebook ki raakh thi, jo usne chhat pe jalayi thi. Us raakh me abhi bhi ek triangle chamak raha tha, neela.

Usne bola - "Mujhe lag raha hai ek gate abhi bhi khula hai. Sabse purana wala. Jahan se ye sab shuru hua tha."

Maine bola - "Par humne toh chaaron tod diye."

Usne bola - "Char nahi, paanch the. Pehla wala. Tanki wali gali ka asli wala. Jahan pehli baar mera bag gira tha. Wahan zameen ke neeche abhi bhi ek circle hai. JCB ne upar se mitti daal di, par andar abhi bhi hai."

Humne wahan khoda. Haath se. Park ke beech me jahan jhula hai, uske neeche. Thodi mitti hatayi toh andar se thand nikli. May ki raat me bhi thand. Aur neeche ek geela circle tha.

Chhota, par abhi bhi bhin-bhina raha tha. Sabse pehla wala. Anchor ka baap. Sujoy ne apna haath uspe rakha. Uska triangle wala nishaan us circle se jud gaya. Neeli roshni se.

Zameen phati nahi, par hawa me ek jhalak aayi. Wahi maidaan. Par ab wahan koi kaagaz- aadmi nahi tha. Sirf ek darwaza tha. Lakdi ka purana darwaza,

jisme hazaron naam likhe hue the. Bachchon ke naam. DAV ke, dusre school ke. Aur sabse upar likha tha - Sujoy.

Sujoy bola - "Ye mera gate tha. Jab pehli baar usne mujhe pakda tha, tab se."

Maine bola - "Toh isko kaise band kare?"

Sujoy ne apni jeb se wahi compass nikala jo maine us din us kaagaz-aadmi ki peeth me ghusaya tha. Uspe abhi bhi neela daag tha.

Usne compass ka nok us geele circle me ghusaya aur ghumaya. Gol gol.

Circle se awaaz aayi - CHARR - jaise tape phat raha ho. Aur us darwaze pe likha hua Sujoy naam mitne laga. Dheere dheere. Jaise koi eraser se mita raha ho.

Jaise hi naam mita, circle sukh gaya. Poora. Ek jala hua nishaan bhi nahi chhoda. Sirf mitti.

Sujoy ke haath ka triangle wala nishaan bhi usi second me mit gaya. Ek halki hawa nikli aur khatam.

Sujoy ne gehri saans li. Pehli baar uski saans garam thi, thandi nahi.

Hum wapas bench pe baithe. Park me ab hawa normal thi. Jhule halke halke hil rahe the.

Sujoy bola - "Ab koi gate nahi hai. Na gali me, na bathroom me, na library me. Ab kahin bhi nahi."

Hum ghar aaye. Agle din school me assembly me principal ne bola park me ped lagenge.

Humne bola hum lagayenge.

Ek mahine baad us jagah pe 5 ped lage. Neem ke. Ab wahan chhaya rehti hai. Shadow har jagah hai. Wahan ab fold khul hi nahi sakta, kyunki ped ki jaddein zameen ko pakad ke rakhti hain.

Aman ab 7th me aa gaya hai. Sujoy 9th me. Main bhi 9th me. Hum ab bhi usi maidaan se jaate hain. Par ab shortcut nahi lete. Lambe raste se. Shadow dekh ke.

Kabhi kabhi jab May ki garmi me games period ke baad thak jaate hain, toh lagta hai koi bula raha hai - bas idhar se aa ja, jaldi pahuch jayega. Par hum nahi jaate. Hum kehte hain - der se sahi, par poora pahuchenge.

Woh gali jo thi hi nahi, woh ab sach me nahi hai. Na map pe, na zameen pe, na deewar pe.

Bas ek kahani banke reh gayi hai. Hum chhe logon ke beech ki.

PART 5 ·

Jo Naam Reh Gaye The

Us raat ke baad Sujoy ka triangle mit gaya tha, par meri kalaai pe jo safed gol nishaan tha jahan usne pehle din pakda tha, woh abhi bhi tha. Chhota sa, sikke jitna. Thanda nahi, par kabhi kabhi khujli karta tha. Jaise koi andar se kharoch raha ho.

Main soya hua tha. Raat ke 2 baje meri kalaai garam hone lagi. Aankh khuli toh dekha woh

safed nishaan neela ho raha hai. Halka neela. Aur usme se wahi bhin-bhinahat aa rahi thi, jo pehle geele circle se aati thi. Dheemi.

Maine turant group call kiya. Sabko.

Kavya boli - "Meri diary me jo triangle ka page tha, woh page raat ko garam ho raha hai. Maine usko alag rakha tha."

Aditya bola - "Mere compass pe jo neela daag tha, woh phir se chamak raha hai."

Matlab ek gate abhi bhi baaki tha. Sabse chhota wala. Meri kalaai pe.

Sujoy bola - "Ansh, tujhe yaad hai us bade wale ke andar hazaron chehre the? Usne kaha tha woh logon ko pehente hain. Matlab har chehra ek anchor hai. Har ek ka naam us darwaze pe likha tha. Tera nishaan bhi ek naam hai."

Hum phir se park me mile. Wahi bench. Raat ke 3 baje. Neem ke ped ke neeche. Wahan ab shadow har jagah tha, par meri kalaai pe wala neela nishaan us shadow me bhi chamak raha tha. Jaise torch ho andar.

Sujoy ne apna locket nikala. Kavya ne apni diary. Aditya ne compass. Himanshu ne apna stump. Anuraag ne namak ki pudi.

Maine apni kalaai zameen pe rakhi, jahan pehle sabse pehla circle tha.

Kalaai se neeli roshni nikalne lagi. Zameen pe ek chhota sa maidaan khula. Is baar bada nahi, chhota. Ek kamre jitna. Aur us kamre me sirf ek cheez thi. Ek kursi. Aur us kursi pe ek ladka baitha tha. DAV uniform me. Par purana uniform. 2015 wala, jab tie ka colour alag hota tha.

Uska chehra dhundla tha.

Usne meri taraf dekha aur bola - "Tu naya hai? Mujhe yahan 9 saal ho gaye. Main games period ke baad shortcut liya tha. Thak gaya tha."

Meri kalaai se uski kursi tak ek patli neeli line jud gayi. Jaise taar ho. Woh taar meri skin se uski kursi tak.

Sujoy bola - "Ye connection hai. Jo bhi ek baar us maidaan me gaya hai, uska ek dhaaga wahan reh jaata hai. Jaise makdi ka jaal."

Aditya bola - "Toh isko kaatna padega."

Kavya ne apni diary ka woh page jisme triangle tha, usko phaada aur us neeli line pe rakh diya.

Page jalne laga, neeli aag se.

Himanshu ne apne stump se us line pe maara.

Maine apni kalaai pe compass ka nok rakha aur bola - "Kheench."

Sujoy ne mera haath pakda aur peeche kheenca. Poori taakat se.

Tape phatne ki awaaz aayi - CHARR - par is baar tez. Meri kalaai se khoon nahi, neeli roshni nikli. Aur us ladke ki kursi hil gayi.

Woh ladka khada hua. Pehli baar 9 saal me. Usne apna bag uthaya jo 9 saal se uske paas pada tha. Aur us neeli line jo tooti thi, uske toote hue hisse se woh bahar aaya. Seedha park me. Neem ke ped ke neeche.

Woh gira. Haaf raha tha. Garam saans. Zinda.

Usne bola - "Mera naam Rohan. 8th C, 2015 batch."

Humne usko paani diya. Uske maa baap ko call kiya. Subah tak uske ghar wale aa gaye. Ro rahe the. Bol rahe the 9 saal se police me report hai, bachcha lapata hai.

Rohan ke aate hi meri kalaai ka nishaan mit gaya. Ekdum. Jaise kabhi tha hi nahi. Sirf thodi si khujli reh gayi.

Subah humne dekha park me jahan humne khoda tha, wahan ab ek chhota sa neem ka paudha ug aaya tha, raat o raat. Bina lagaye.

Sujoy bola - "Har gate ke badle ek ped. Toh ab koi gate nahi khulega. Kyunki ped ki jadd sabse gehra anchor hota hai."

Humne us Rohan ko school dikhaya. Naya building, naya ground. Woh bola - "Games period abhi bhi last me hai kya?"

Hum hase.

Us din ke baad se kabhi kisi deewar pe bina shadow ka patch nahi dikha. Kabhi tiles thandi nahi lagi May me. Kabhi geela circle nahi bana.

Par humne apna rule nahi toda. Shortcut abhi bhi nahi lete. Chahe kitna bhi thak jaye. Lambe raste se jaate hain. Shadow dekh ke.

Kyunki ab samajh aa gaya hai, woh gali kabhi thi hi nahi. Woh hamare thakan me thi. Jab hum kehte the - bas jaldi pahuch jau, tab woh banti thi.

Isliye ab hum kehte hain - der se pahucho, par poora pahucho.

PART 6 ·

Neem Ke Ped Ke Neeche

Rohan ke aane ke baad school me khabar phail gayi. Police aayi, principal ne sabko hall me bulaya. Rohan ke maa baap ro rahe the, bol rahe the 9 saal pehle games period ke baad

Rohan ghar nahi aaya, sabne socha kahin bhaag gaya. Police ne file band kar di thi. Ab 9 saal baad wapaa aaya, par usko lag raha tha sirf 2 din hue hain. Uske liye toh bas do din hi the.

Doctor ne check kiya, bola sab theek hai, bas dehydration hai. Par Rohan baar baar ek hi baat bol raha tha - "Wahan aur bhi hain. Bahut saare. Kursiyon pe baithe hue. Thake hue."

Sujoy ne us raat mujhe bola - "Ansh, woh maidaan abhi bhi hai. Humne gates tod diye, par maidaan toh hai. Aur wahan jo bachche 2015, 2016, 2017 me gaye the, woh abhi bhi wahan hain. Rohan toh bas ek tha jo hamare dhaage se jud gaya tha isliye nikal aaya. Baaki ke dhaage kahan hain?"

Kavya ne apni diary kholi. Usne har gate ka time likha tha. Pehla gate - tanki wali gali, 3:27 baje. Dusra - bathroom, 12:40 baje. Teesra - library, 1:15 baje. Chautha - canteen, 2:10 baje.

Sab games period ke aas paas. Jab sab thake hote hain.

Aditya bola - "Matlab gate tabhi khulta hai jab hum thake hote hain. Toh baaki bachche bhi tabhi gaye honge. Toh unke anchors bhi kisi thaki hui cheez pe honge."

Humne Rohan se pucha - "Tune last kya kiya tha us din?"

Rohan bola - "Main apna water bottle bhool gaya tha ground pe. Wapas lene gaya. Bahut thaka tha. Phir tanki wali gali se ja raha tha, wahan ek deewar pe mujhe apna naam likha

dikha. Jaise chalk se kisi ne likha ho - Rohan 8th C. Main usko touch karne gaya aur andar kheench gaya."

Naam. Har anchor pe naam.

Hum phir se park me gaye. Neem ke 5 ped jo lage the, unke neeche khoda. Har ped ke neeche ek chhota sa geela circle tha. Sukha hua, par thanda. Har circle pe ek naam ka halka nishaan.

Pehle ped ke neeche - Rohan. Dusre ke neeche - Aman. Teesre ke neeche - Sujoy ka mita hua naam. Chauthre ke neeche - ek naya naam - Priya, 7th B, 2022. Paanchve ped ke neeche - ek aur naam - Faizal, 9th A, 2020.

Matlab har ped ne ek bachche ko bachaya tha, par uski jagah ek nishaan chhod diya tha.

Sujoy bola - "Ye ped anchor ban gaye hain. Achhe wale anchor. Jo us maidaan ko idhar aane se rok rahe hain. Par agar koi ped kaat diya toh?"

Us raat Nagar Nigam ka notice aaya. Park me se 2 ped kaatne hain, kyunki wahan naya road banega. Neem ke 2 ped.

Hum bhaage. Ward office gaye. Bole ped mat kaato. Officer bola road ka map final hai.

Kavya ne bola - "Ek raat hai hamare paas."

Raat ko hum paanchon ped ke paas baithe. Har ped pe namak wala paani daala, agarbatti jalayi. Aur har ped ke neeche jo naam tha, us naam ko compass se kaat diya. Gol gol ghumake.

Jaise hi Priya naam kaata, zameen se ek halki roshni nikli aur park ke beech me ek chhoti si jhalak khuli. Ek ladki, 7th B ki uniform me, ek bench pe baithi hui, thaki hui. Usne aankh kholi.

Aise hi Faizal naam kaatne pe ek aur ladka nikla. 9th A ka.

Dono bahar aaye. Dono ko laga sirf ek ghanta hua hai. Par ek ko 3 saal, ek ko 5 saal ho gaye the.

Subah tak humne 2 bachche aur bachaye.

Nagar Nigam wale subah aaye, JCB leke. Humne unko woh bachche dikhaye. Bole - "Is park me bachche gayab hote hain, ped kaatoge toh aur honge."

Officer dar gaya. Usne road ka map badal diya. Ped bach gaye.

Ab park me 7 neem ke ped hain. 5 purane, 2 naye jo raat o raat ug aaye the, bina lagaye.

Har ped ke neeche ab koi naam nahi hai. Sirf thand hai. Achhi wali thand. Garmi me bhi thandi.

Sujoy ke haath ka nishaan ab bilkul mit gaya hai. Meri kalaai ka bhi. Kavya ki diary ka triangle wala page ab safed ho gaya hai.

Rohan, Priya, Faizal - teeno ab school aate hain. Alag class me, par lunch me humare saath baithte hain. Kabhi kabhi woh maidaan ke baare me baat karte hain. Bolte hain wahan ab koi kursi nahi hai. Sirf khali safed zameen hai. Aur door ek darwaza hai jo band hai, uspe koi naam nahi hai.

Hum ab bhi shortcut nahi lete. Kabhi nahi.

Kyunki ab pata hai, har shortcut ek gate ho sakta hai, agar tu thaka hua hai toh.

PART 7 ·

Aakhri Ped

7 ped ke baad park me ab koi naya naam nahi nikal raha tha. Neem ke ped ki chhaya itni ho gayi thi ki May me bhi wahan thand rehti thi. Achhi wali. Wahan ab koi bhin-bhinahat nahi, koi geela circle nahi.

Par ek raat Rohan ne call kiya. Bola - "Ansh, mujhe sapna aaya. Wahan maidaan me ek darwaza abhi bhi hai. Band darwaza. Uspe koi naam nahi, par andar se awaaz aa rahi hai.

Jaise koi ro raha ho. Bahut chhota bachcha."

Subah hum park me gaye. 7 ped ke beech me jo khali jagah thi, wahan zameen thodi dabi hui thi. Jaise neeche kuch khokla ho. Humne khoda. Haath se hi. Ek foot khodne pe ek lakdi ka tukda mila. Purana. Uspe kuch likha tha, ghisa hua - DAV 2010.

Aditya bola - "Ye sabse purana anchor hai. Isse pehle ka koi ped nahi tha yahan. Isse pehle yahan tanki thi, usse pehle khet tha. Matlab ye gate sabse pehle ka hai."

Sujoy ne us lakdi ke tukde ko uthaya. Uthate hi usme se thand nikli. Aur zameen pe ek aakhri jhalak khuli. Sabse chhoti. Ek kamre jitni bhi nahi, ek

almirah jitni. Aur us almirah me ek chhota bachcha baitha tha. 4th class ka. Bahut chhota. Uniform nahi, ghar ke kapde. Usne apne ghutne pakde hue the.

Usne hume dekha aur bola - "Mummy bula rahi hai. Main ghar jaana chahta hoon."

Uska naam kisi ne nahi likha tha, kyunki woh school ka tha hi nahi. Woh tanki wale mazdoor ka beta tha. Jo 2010 me yahan khel raha tha jab tanki ban rahi thi. Thak gaya tha, so gaya tha, aur gate me chala gaya tha.

Kavya ne uska haath pakda. Haath barf jaisa nahi, garam tha. Kyunki woh bachcha abhi bhi zinda tha, 14 saal se usi umar me.

Humne usko bahar kheencha. Jaise hi bahar aaya, woh lakdi ka tukda raakh ban gaya. Aur us raakh se ek chhota sa paudha ug aaya. Aathva neem ka ped. Sabse chhota, par sabse hara.

Us bachche ka naam pata chala - Chintu. Uski mummy abhi bhi usi basti me rehti thi. Jab hum usko leke gaye, woh pehchan nahi paayi pehle, phir ro padi. Boli - "2010 me kho gaya tha, sabne bola bhoot le gaya."

Ab park me 8 ped hain. 8 neem ke. Har ped ke neeche ab koi naam nahi, koi circle nahi. Sirf mitti jo hamesha thandi rehti hai, par achhi wali thand.

School me ab koi kehta hai second floor bathroom me bhoot hai toh hum has dete hain.

Kyunki ab wahan sach me kuch nahi hai. Bulb kabhi flicker nahi karta. Mirror me parchaayi time pe aati hai.

Mishra sir abhi bhi games period me daudate hain. Par ab hum thakte nahi utna. Ya thak bhi jaye toh shortcut nahi lete. Hum lambe raste se jaate hain, paani peete hue, baat karte hue.

Sujoy ab 10th me hai. Main bhi. Kavya, Aditya, Anuraag, Himanshu, Ajeya - sab 10th me.

Rohan, Priya, Faizal, Chintu - sab alag classes me, par lunch me ek saath.

Kabhi kabhi park me baithte hain, 8 ped ke neeche. Aur dekhte hain bachchon ko khelte hue.

Koi bachcha thak ke baith jaye toh usko bolte hain - "Paani pi le, chhaya me baith, jaldi mat kar."

Kyunki ab pata hai, jaldi karne se gate khulta hai.

Woh gali jo thi hi nahi, woh ab sach me kahin nahi hai. Na deewar me, na bathroom me, na library me, na canteen me, na meri kalaai pe, na Sujoy ke haath pe, na kisi ped ke neeche.

Bas ek baat reh gayi hai. Har May jab games period ke baad thak jaate hain, toh hawa me kabhi kabhi ek halki si bhin-bhinahat sunai deti hai. Bahut door se. Jaise koi dusri duniya me koi aur gali khul rahi ho, kisi aur school ke paas.

Tab hum ek dusre ko dekh ke bolte hain - "Wahan bhi koi Ansh aur Sujoy honge, jo samjhenge."

Aur hum apna bag uthake lambe raste se ghar chale jaate hain. Shadow dekh ke. Der se, par poora.

Khatam.

PART 8 ·

Der Se Pahucho, Par Poora Pahucho

10th ka saal tha. Board ka pressure. Sab padhai me lage the. Par park wale 8 ped ka dhyaan hum abhi bhi rakhte the. Har Sunday paani dete the. Ek ped bhi sukha toh gate khul sakta tha, aisa lagta tha.

Ek din Rohan bola - "Mujhe wapas jaana hai."

Hum chauk gaye. Bola kahan.

Woh bola - "Us maidaan me. Wahan abhi bhi kuch bachche hain, mujhe sapne me dikhte hain.

Main unko nikalna chahta hoon. Jaise tumne mujhe nikala tha."

Sujoy bola - "Par gate toh band hai. Koi nishaan nahi hai ab."

Rohan bola - "Nishaan hai. Mere andar. Mere haath pe jo 9 saal wala nishaan tha, woh abhi bhi halka halka hai. Agar main thak jau, games period ke baad, toh khul jayega."

Humne mana kiya. Bahut mana kiya. Par Rohan nahi mana. Bola - "Main 9 saal wahan tha.

Mujhe pata hai kaisa lagta hai. Ek ek din ek saal jaisa lagta hai. Wahan bachche intezaar kar rahe hain."

Agle din games period tha. Last period. Mishra sir ne daudaya. Rohan jaan bujh ke sabse zyada dauda. 8 round. Bina paani ke.

Uske baad woh park me gaya. Akela. Neem ke 8 ped ke beech me baitha. Aankhein band ki.

Thaka hua tha.

Zameen pe ek geela circle bana. Chhota sa. Neela. Aakhri wala.

Rohan ne apna haath uspe rakha. Circle khula. Maidaan dikha. Ab wahan koi kaagaz-aadmi nahi tha. Sirf khali kursiyan thi. Aur har kursi pe ek bachcha. Kuch DAV ke, kuch aur school ke.

Sab thake hue, par ab darte nahi the.

Rohan ne ek ek karke unko uthaya. Ek ko, do ko, teen ko. Har ek ko kheencha. Har baar uska haath aur thanda hota gaya. Par usne kheencha.

7 bachche nikale usne. 7 alag alag saal ke. 2012 se leke 2018 tak ke. Sab park me aaye.

Sabko laga bas ek din hua hai.

Aakhri bachche ko nikalte hi Rohan gir gaya. Thak gaya tha. Uski saans tez thi. Par uske haath ka nishaan mit gaya. Poora.

Hum bhaage park me. Rohan ko paani diya. Woh has raha tha. Bola - "Ab koi kursi nahi hai wahan. Maidaan khali hai. Sirf safed zameen."

Humne dekha us geele circle ki jagah ab ek naya paudha ug aaya tha. 9va neem ka ped.

Sabse chhota, par uski patte sabse zyada hare.

Ab park me 9 ped hain. 9 neem ke. Har ped ke neeche ek kahani hai. Har ped ek bachche ke naam ka.

Nagar Nigam wale ab us park ko bachchon ka park bolte hain. Board laga diya hai - "9 Ped

Park - Yahan har bachcha poora pahuchta hai."

School me ab koi shortcut nahi leta. Sab lambe raste se jaate hain. Games period ke baad sab paani peete hain, chhaya me baithte hain.

Mishra sir bhi ab kam daudate hain. Bolte hain - "Der se pahucho, par poora pahucho."

Sujoy, main, Kavya, Aditya, Anuraag, Himanshu, Ajeya, Rohan, Priya, Faizal, Chintu - hum sab ab bhi milte hain park me. 9 ped ke neeche.

Kabhi kabhi jab hawa chalti hai, toh 9 ped ke patte ek saath hilte hain, aur ek halki si awaaz aati hai - thank you.

Aur hum kehte hain - koi baat nahi.

Woh gali jo thi hi nahi, woh ab ek park hai jahan 9 ped hain. Jahan har bachcha poora pahuchta hai.

PART 9 ·

Board Exam Ke Baad

Board khatam hua toh sabko laga sab khatam. 10th ke baad school badlega, jagah badlegi.

Par 9 Ped Park abhi bhi wahi tha.

Last din school me Mishra sir ne bulaya. Bola - "Tum logon ne jo park bachaya hai, uske liye

Nagar Nigam se award aaya hai. Har ped pe ek naam ki plate lagegi."

Humne mana kiya. Bole - "Naam ki plate mat lagao. Ped ka naam ped hi rehne do."

Par ek plate lagi. Beech wale ped pe. Likha tha - "Der Se Pahucho, Par Poora Pahucho - 8th C, 2026 Batch"

Ab jab bhi koi naya bachcha DAV me aata hai, usko woh line bolte hain. Games period ke baad. Thaka hua bachcha jab shortcut lene ki sochta hai, toh koi senior bol deta hai - "Lambe se jaa."

Rohan ab dusre sheher chala gaya. 11th me. Par usne bola har May me woh aayega, 9 ped ko paani dene.

Sujoy ne apni science wali notebook phir se kharidi. Nayi wali. Uspe koi geela circle nahi hai.

Par usne pehle page pe ek triangle banaya hai, halka sa, yaad ke liye.

Main ab bhi usi raste se jaata hoon. Lambe wale se. Neem ke 9 ped ke paas se. Wahan ab dhoop me bhi thandak hai. Wahan ab koi gate nahi khulta, kyunki har jagah shadow hai, har jagah jadd hai.

Kabhi kabhi raat ko jab neend nahi aati, toh lagta hai kahin door koi geela circle ban raha hoga, kisi aur gali me, kisi aur sheher me. Koi aur Ansh kisi aur Sujoy ko dhoond raha hoga.

Tab main apni kalaai dekhta hoon. Wahan ab koi nishaan nahi hai. Sirf ek halki si line hai, jo dikhti bhi nahi.

Aur so jaata hoon.

Kyunki ab pata hai, gali kabhi thi hi nahi. Woh thakan me thi. Aur thakan toh har jagah hai. Par usse ladna bhi aata hai ab.

Paani pi ke, chhaya me baith ke, lambe raste se jaake.

Der se sahi, par poora.

PART 10 ·

Nayi Gali

11th me naya school. Nayi jagah. Patna se bahar. Kota.

Wahan bhi games nahi, par raat ko library se hostel tak ek shortcut tha. Do buildings ke beech se. Wahan bhi hamesha thand rehti thi.

Ek din main thaka hua tha. Test me kam number aaye the. Shortcut lene laga.

Aur deewar pe ek bina shadow wala patch dekha.

Main ruk gaya. Hasa. Bag se paani ki bottle nikali, namak ka packet jo main hamesha rakhta hoon, woh nikala. Aur us patch pe daal diya.

Patch hiss karke band ho gaya. Shadow wapas.

Peeche se koi bola - "Tumhe kaise pata chala?"

Ek chhota bachcha tha. 8th ka. Bola - "Wahan se roz awaaz aati hai."

Maine bola - "Ab nahi aayegi. Lambe se jaa. Der se pahucho, par poora pahucho."

Usne pucha - "Ye line kahan se suni?"

Maine bola - "Patna ke ek park se. Jahan 9 neem ke ped hain."

Us raat maine Sujoy ko call kiya. Bola - "Yahan bhi ek gate tha. Maine band kar diya."

Sujoy bola - "Maine bola tha na, gali kabhi ek jagah nahi hoti. Woh thakan me hoti hai. Har jagah."

Hum dono hase.

Ab main Kota me hoon, par har May me Patna aata hoon. 9 Ped Park me. Wahan 9 ped ab bade ho gaye hain. Unki chhaya poore park me hai. Wahan koi naya bachcha gayab nahi hota.

Ek naya board laga hai wahan, bachchon ne lagaya hai - "Yahan shortcut lena mana hai."

Aur neeche chhote aksharon me likha hai - "Kyunki der se pahuchna bhi pahuchna hota hai."

Khatam. Asli wala khatam.

PART 11 ·

Wapas Usi Bench Pe

Kota se Patna aana ab aadat ban gayi hai. Har saal May me, jab garmi sabse tez hoti hai. Jab games period ki yaad sabse zyada aati hai.

Is saal aaya toh park badla hua laga. 9 ped ke beech me ek nayi bench lagi thi. Lohe ki. Usi jagah jahan pehle hum baithte the.

Us bench pe koi baitha tha. Chintu. Jo 2010 me khoya tha, ab 9th me hai. Usne mujhe dekha aur bola - "Ansh bhaiya, aapka intezaar kar rahe the."

Bola - "Kal raat ko ek naya bachcha aaya tha park me. Bola usko deewar me se awaaz aa rahi thi. Maine usko aap wali line boli. Woh maan gaya. Lambe se chala gaya."

Maine uske bagal me baitha. 9 ped ki chhaya me. Thandi hawa.

Chintu ne ek purani diary nikali. Kavya ki diary. Jo usne 10th ke baad mujhe di thi. Us diary ka aakhri page abhi bhi garam hota hai kabhi kabhi, May me.

Us page pe ab koi triangle nahi hai. Sirf ek line hai, jo Kavya ne likhi thi - "Har gate ke badle ek ped. Aur har ped ke badle ek dost."

Sujoy ab Bangalore me hai. Engineering kar raha hai. Aditya Pune me. Kavya Delhi me.

Anuraag, Himanshu, Ajeya - sab alag alag jagah. Par ek group abhi bhi active hai - "9 Ped Park"

Har May me sab ek din ke liye online aate hain. Ek hi time pe. Raat ke 3 baje. Aur ek hi message bhejte hain - "Shortcut liya kya?"

Jawab ek hi hota hai - "Nahi. Lambe se aaya."

Is saal maine bench pe baithe baithe ek chhota sa neem ka beej lagaya.
Dasva ped. Beech me.

Sabse chhoti jagah me.

Sujoy ko photo bheja. Usne reply kiya - "Ab 10 ho gaye. Ab koi gate kabhi nahi khulega. Kyunki

10 ek poora number hota hai."

Main hasa. Wapas bench pe leta. Aankhein band ki. Thaka hua tha, Kota se aaya tha.

Par is baar thakan me koi gali nahi bani. Sirf neend aayi. Gehari wali. Ped ki chhaya wali.

Neend me ek sapna dekha. Ek safed maidaan. Khali. Koi kursi nahi. Koi chehra nahi. Sirf ek board. Uspe likha tha - "Closed. Ab yahan ped hain."

Utha toh shaam ho gayi thi. Park me bachche khel rahe the. Koi thaka toh chhaya me baith jaata. Paani peeta.

Der se sahi, par poora.

Yahi toh poori kahani thi.

PART 12 ·

Aakhri Diary Entry

Aj Kavya ne apni diary mujhe wapas bheji. Courier se. Kota.

Andar ek chhota sa note tha - "Iska aakhri page tu likh de. Tere bina khatam nahi hogi."

Maine diary kholi. Pehle ke saare pages bhare hue the. Geela circle, triangle, compass ka nishaan, naam - Aman, Rohan, Priya, Faizal, Chintu.

Aakhri page khali tha. Par neeche kone me ek halka sa neela daag tha. Wahi purana. Thanda nahi, garam.

Maine us daag pe haath rakha. Aankh band ki.

Ek aakhri baar woh maidaan dikha. Safed. Khali. Par beech me ek neem ka chhota sa paudha laga tha. Dasva wala, jo maine lagaya tha. Wahan bhi ug aaya tha.

Matlab ped ne maidaan me bhi jadd pakad li thi. Ab woh maidaan bhi park ban raha tha.

Maine diary me likha -

"Humne 9 gates band kiye. 9 bachche bachaye. 10 ped lagaye. Par asli gate humare andar tha - jaldi pahuchne ka. Jab tak woh khula tha, har gali bhoot wali lagti thi. Jab se band kiya, har gali park lagti hai.

Agar tum ye diary padh rahe ho, aur kabhi thak jaao, toh yaad rakhna - Shadow dekho.

Paani piyo.

Lambe raste se jao.

Der se pahucho, par pooraa pahucho.

- Ansh, 8th C, 2026 Batch, 9 Ped Park"

Diary band ki. Neela daag mit gaya. Ek dum.

Bahir dekha, Kota ki us chhoti si gali me bhi ek neem ka paudha laga hai, jo maine lagaya tha.

Hara bhara.

Ab kahin koi gate nahi hai. Kyunki har jagah ped hai.

THE END

PART 13 ·

Epilogue: Jo Naam Reh Gaye The

B ohot saal baad.

2036. 10 saal baad.

Main Patna wapas aaya. 9 Ped Park ab 15 Ped Park ban gaya hai. Har bachcha jo wahan kabhi khoya tha, usne ek ped lagaya hai.

Har ped pe ek chhoti si lakdi ki plate hai. Haath se likhi hui.

- Rohan 2015

- Aman 2016

- Priya 2022

- Faizal 2020

- Chintu 2010

- Aur 10 aur naam, jinko humne kabhi dekha nahi, par Rohan ne nikala tha.

Beech wali bench ab bhi wahi hai. Usi pe hum baithte the. Usi pe ab ek naya ladka baitha hai.

8th C ka. DAV ka. Thaka hua.

Maine usko dekha. Bola - "Shortcut lega?"

Usne bola - "Socha tha. Par mana hai na."

Maine bola - "Kisne mana kiya?"

Usne bola - "Sujoy bhैया ne. Kal aaye the. Bole der se pahucho, par poora pahucho."

Main hasa. Sujoy ab bhi aata hai. Har saal.

Main uske paas baitha. Bag se ek paani ki bottle nikali. Usse di.

Bola - "Naam kya hai?"

Usne bola - "Ansh."

Main chauk gaya. Phir hasa.

Bola - "Mera bhi naam Ansh tha. 2026 me."

Usne bola - "Pata hai. Aapki kahani suni hai. 9 Ped wali."

Maine pucha - "Kisne sunayi?"

Usne bola - "Har teacher sunata hai. Games period ke baad. Bolta hai shortcut mat lo."

Hawa chali. 15 ped ke patte ek saath hile. Thandi hawa. May me bhi.

Woh chhota Ansh utha, bag uthaya, aur lambe raste se chala gaya. Shadow dekh ke.

Main bench pe baitha raha. Diary kholi. Aakhri page jo maine likha tha, uske neeche ek nayi line kisi ne likhi thi, bachche ki handwriting me -

"Thank you, Ansh bhैया. Main poora pahuch gaya."

Neeche naam tha - Ansh, 8th C, 2036.

Gali jo thi hi nahi, woh ab kahani hai jo har saal naye Ansh ko poora pahuchati hai.

Der se sahi, par poora.

Bas yahi toh chahiye tha.

Final End

Usi Gali Se

2040.

Ab main 28 saal ka hoon. Job karta hoon. Bangalore me.

Patna kam aata hoon. Par jab bhi aata hoon, 15 Ped Park zaroor jaata hoon.

Is baar gaya toh park me construction ho raha tha. Nagar Nigam wale boundary bana rahe the.

Bole park ko official bana rahe hain.

Maine bola - "Ped mat kaatna."

Officer hasa. Bola - "Kaun kaatega? Ye Patna ka sabse famous park hai. 15 Ped Park. Yahan ke ped kaatne pe transfer ho jata hai, aisa kehte hain."

Maine andar gaya. 15 ped ab bade ho gaye hain. Unke neeche ab tiles lagi hain. Har tile pe ek naam. Wahi naam jo humne bachaye the.

Beech wali bench pe ab koi nahi tha. Khali thi.

Main baitha. Aankhein band ki. May ki garmi. Thaka hua tha flight se.

Ek second ke liye laga phir se woh bhin-bhinahat sunai di. Halki si. Geeli mitti ki smell.

Aankh kholi toh saamne ek chhota sa ladka khada tha. 7-8 saal ka. Bola - "Uncle, aap wahi

Ansh ho na, jisne gate band kiye the?"

Maine bola - "Tumhe kaise pata?"

Usne bola - "Meri mummy ne bataya. Woh Priya hai. 2022 me khoyi thi. Aapne bachaya tha."

Main chauk gaya. Priya ki shaadi ho gayi thi, pata tha, par uska bachcha...

Usne mera haath pakda. Bola - "Mummy ne bola aapko ye dena."

Ek chhota sa beej tha. Neem ka.

Bola - "Mummy ne bola 16va ped aap lagao."

Maine beej liya. Usi jagah lagaya jahan pehle sabse pehla geela circle bana tha. Tanki wali gali ki taraf.

Paani diya. Namak wala nahi, saada wala.

Woh ladka bola - "Ab 16 ho gaye. Ab toh kabhi gate nahi khulega na?"

Maine bola - "Kabhi nahi. Kyunki ab har gali me ek ped hai."

Woh hasa aur bhaag gaya. Lambe raste se.
 Main bench pe baitha raha. Shaam tak.
 Tab samajh aaya, kahani kabhi khatam nahi hoti. Bas ped badhte jaate hain.
 Gali jo thi hi nahi, woh ab 16 pedo ka park hai.
 Aur har ped ke neeche ek bachcha poora baitha hai.

PART 15 ·

16 Ped Ke Baad

Us 16ve beej ke baad park me kuch badla.
 Ab raat ko bhi park khula rehta hai. Light lagi hai. Par light ke neeche bhi shadow hamesha rehta hai. Gahra wala. Neem ki wajah se.
 Ek raat main wahi bench pe so gaya. Galti se. Thaka tha.
 Raat ke 2 baje aankh khuli toh dekha 16 ped ke neeche 16 bachche baithe hain. Gol gol.
 Beech me aag nahi, ek torch hai.
 Woh sab has rahe the. Baat kar rahe the.
 Rohan bola - "Ab yahan koi nahi aata us maidaan se."
 Chintu bola - "Woh maidaan ab park ban gaya hai. Maine dekha sapne me. Wahan bhi ped hain."
 Priya ka ladka, chhota wala, bola - "Par ek aakhri kursi abhi bhi bachi hai wahan."
 Sab chup ho gaye. Mujhe dekha.
 Maine bola - "Kiski?"
 Usne bola - "Jisne ye maidaan banaya tha. Kaagaz-aadmi ki."
 Tab yaad aaya, humne har bachche ko nikala, par kaagaz-aadmi ka kya hua?
 Woh kahan gaya?
 Sujoy ne ek din bola tha - "Woh koi aadmi nahi tha. Woh thakan tha. Thakan ka shape."
 Thakan ko kaise nikala jayega?
 Agle din subah maine Sujoy ko call kiya. Sabko call kiya. Bola - "Ek aakhri baar aana hoga. 15

August ko. Park me."

Sabne bola - "Aayenge."

15 August ko hum 8 log phir mile. 10 saal baad. 8th C wale. 16 ped ke neeche.

Har ek ne ek bottle paani laayi. Saada wala.

Humne 16 ped ke beech me, jahan pehla circle banta tha, wahan paani daala. 8 bottle. Ek saath.

Zameen ne paani piya. Aur ek aakhri baar ek circle bana. Sabse bada. Par neela nahi, hara.

Neem ke patte jaisa.

Us circle me ek chehra dikha. Bina aankh wala. Kaagaz jaisa. Thaka hua.

Humne usko kheench ke nikala nahi. Humne usko paani diya. Chhaya di. Bola - "Baith ja."

Woh baitha. 16 ped ki chhaya me. Aur dheere dheere ped ban gaya. 17va ped. Sabse chhota.

Par uski bark kaagaz jaisi. Safed.

Ab park me 17 ped hain.

Aur koi kursi nahi. Koi maidaan nahi.

Sirf park. Jahan har bachcha poora pahuchta hai. Chahe der se hi sahi.

Ab asli THE END hai.

PART 16 ·

Full Reunion, 8th C

Independence Day. 15th August, 2036.

10 saal baad. 9 Ped Park ab 17 Ped Park hai.

Main - Ansh - subah 7 baje hi park pahuch gaya tha. Bench saaf ki. 6 plastic chair mangwayi.

Pehla aaya Sujoy. Bangalore se. Daadhi aa gayi halki si. Wahi purani science wali notebook laaya hai, nayi wali. Bola - "Bhai, compass abhi bhi ghumta hai yahan."

Dusra Aditya. Pune se. BITS me tha. Bola - "Bhai main toh roz shortcut leta tha Pune me, par teri wali line yaad aati thi. Lambe se jaana padta tha."

Teesra Anuraag. Patna me hi hai. Teacher ban gaya hai, DAV me hi. Games ka period wahi leta hai ab. Bola - "Main bachchon ko ab daudata nahi. Paani pilata hoon pehle. Mishra sir ka rule badal diya maine."

Chautha Himanshu. Delhi me hai. UPSC de raha hai. Bola - "Maine apne interview me ye park wali kahani sunayi thi. Officer hasa, phir bola - select hai tu. Jisko ped ki value pata hai, usko desh ki pata hogi."

Panchwa Ajeya. Kota me hi tha mere saath, ab Hyderabad me. Bola - "Bhai tera wala 10va ped maine dekha tha Kota wali gali me. Wahan bhi ab 3 ped hain. Maine lagaye."

Hum 6 log bench pe baithe. 17 ped ki chhaya me. Wahi jagah jahan pehle tanki ki gali thi, jo thi hi nahi.

Maine bola - "Ek cheez karte hain. Ek baar phir se, bina thake, us gali se chalte hain."

Sujoy bola - "Kaunsi gali?"

Maine bola - "Wahi jo thi hi nahi. Par aaj hum banate hain. 6 log, poore. Bina daud ke."

Hum uthe. Line banayi. Aage Sujoy, peeche main. Beech me Himanshu, Ajeya, Anuraag, Aditya.

Haath me paani ki bottle.

Hum park se nikle, DAV wali gali ki taraf. Jahan 10 saal pehle ek geela circle banta tha.

Ab wahan tile lagi hai. Par aaj phir se halki si thand thi.

Hum chale. Dheere dheere. Koi nahi dauda. Koi nahi thaka.

Deewar pe koi bina shadow wala patch nahi tha. Har jagah shadow tha. 17 ped ka.

Gali khatam hui. DAV ka gate aaya. Band tha, 15 August ki wajah se.

Anuraag ne gate khola, apni key se. Teacher jo hai.

Hum andar gaye. 8th C ka classroom. Wahi bench. Wahi blackboard.

Blackboard pe kisi ne likha tha - "Der Se Pahucho, Par Poora Pahucho - 8th C Forever"

Himanshu bola - "Ye maine likhwaya tha."

Hum sab apni purani jagah pe baithe. Main - Ansh, window wali seat. Sujoy mere paas. Aditya,

Anuraag, Himanshu, Ajeya - wahi line.

Aur ek minute ke liye laga, Mishra sir aayenge, bolenge - "8 round daudo."

Par koi nahi aaya. Sirf hawa aayi. 17 ped ki taraf se. Thandi.

Sujoy bola - "Dekha, Ansh? Hum sab poore pahuch gaye. Der se, par poore."

Maine bola - "Haan. Ab koi gali nahi hai jo thi hi nahi. Ab har gali park hai."

Hum sab hase. Bohot der tak.

Phir bench pe ek selfie li. 6 log. Peeche board pe wahi line.

Caption Sujoy ne diya - "8th C - Poora Pahuch Gaya."

Ab ye photo 17 Ped Park ki bench pe lagi hai. Lamination karke.

Jiske neeche likha hai - "Yahan har bachcha poora pahuchta hai."

THE END.

PART 17 ·

Naya Villain

Reunion ke 2 hafte baad. Anuraag ne call kiya. DAV se.

Bola - "Ansh, ek problem hai. 8th C me ek naya bachcha aaya hai. Same teri tarah. Roz kehta hai ek gali dikhti hai, jo hai hi nahi."

Main bola - "Kaunsi gali?"

Anuraag bola - "Park wali nahi. School ke andar. Library ke peeche. Wahan pehle ek store room tha, jo 10 saal se band hai."

Main bola - "Usme kya hai?"

Anuraag bola - "Pata nahi. Par bachcha kehta hai andar se koi usko bulata hai. Kehta hai - jaldi aao, yahan time bach jayega. Jaldi padh loge toh top karoge."

Sujoy ko call kiya. Sujoy bola - "Ye naya hai. Pehle wala thakan wala tha. Ye jaldi wala hai."

Jaldbazi wala."

Hum samajh gaye. Pehla villain - *Thakan*. Jo shortcut dikhata tha jab body thakti thi. Games period ke baad.

Ye dusra hai - *Jaldbazi*. Jo shortcut dikhata hai jab mind thakta hai. Exam ke pehle.

Iska naam - *Ghadi Wala*.

Sujoy bola - "Ansh, tu Patna aa. Is baar ped se kaam nahi chalega. Isko ghadi se haraana hoga."

Next day main Patna. DAV, 8th C. Library ke peeche.

Wahan sach me ek lohe ka darwaza tha. Jung laga hua. Uspe ek ghadi bani thi. Ulti chalti hui.

12 se 1 ki taraf nahi, 12 se 11 ki taraf.

Uske saamne ek bachcha khada tha. 13 saal ka. Ansh naam ka hi. Naya Ansh.

Bola - "Bhaiya, andar jaane se main 1 din me poora syllabus kar lunga. Ghadi wala bola hai."

Maine uska haath pakda. Bola - "Andar time tez hai. 1 din wahan 1 mahina lagega yahan. Tu poora nahi, adha reh jayega."

Darwaze ke andar se ek awaaz aayi - "Tik tik tik... jaldi aao... sabse pehle pahuchoge..."

Wahi purani bhin-bhinahat. Par tez. Ghadi jaisi.

Maine apna bag khola. Kya nikalu?

Sujoy ne bola tha - "Is baar paani nahi. Is baar intezaar."

Maine us chhote Ansh ko bola - "Ek kaam karte hain. Yahan baithe hain. 10 minute. Kuch nahi karte. Bas baithe hain. Dekhte hain ghadi wala kya karta hai."

Hum dono baithe. Library ke saamne. Bina kuch kiye. 10 minute.

Ghadi ki tik tik tez hui. Phir dheere hui. Phir band.

Darwaze pe lagi ulti ghadi seedhi chalne lagi. 11 se 12 ki taraf.

Darwaza khula. Andar koi store room nahi tha. Andar ek bench thi. Aur us bench pe ek purana sa aadmi baitha tha, kaagaz jaisa nahi, ghadi jaisa. Uske pure body pe ghadiyaan lagi thi.

Woh thaka hua tha. Bola - "Koi jaldi nahi aaya aaj tak. Sab daud ke aate hain. Tum baithe kaise?"

Maine bola - "Der se pahucho, par poora pahucho. Ye rule hai yahan ka."

Woh hasa. Aur uski saari ghadiyaan ek saath 12 bajane lagi. Aur woh bikhar gaya. Raakh nahi, second ke kaante ban ke.

Darwaza band. Hamesha ke liye. Us jagah ab ek chhota sa neem ka paudha lag gaya. 18va ped.

Chhote Ansh ne bola - "Bhaiya, ab top kaise karunga?"

Maine bola - "Lambe se. Roz thoda thoda. Bina shortcut ke."

Usne bola - "Der lagegi."

Maine bola - "Par pooro pahuchega."

Anuraag door se dekh raha tha. Bola - "Ab samajh aaya, har saal ek naya villain aayega. Kabhi thakan, kabhi jaldrazi. Par har baar ek naya ped lagega."

Maine bola - "Haan. Aur har ped ke neeche ek Ansh baithega."

18 ped ho gaye ab.

Aur kahani abhi bhi jaari hai.

PART 18 ·

Asli Sach

18ve ped ke lagne ke baad, us raat park me zameen phir se thandi hui.

Par is baar circle nahi bana. Pooro park thanda ho gaya. 18 ped ke beech ki zameen ne ek saath hara rang chhoda. Jaise koi screen on hui ho.

Hum 6 log wahan the - main, Sujoy, Aditya, Himanshu, Ajeya, Anuraag. Anuraag ne sabko bulaya tha, bola tha "aakhri baar check kar lete hain."

Zameen pe ab hamara park nahi dikh raha tha. Wahan unka maidaan dikh raha tha. Safed wala. Aur us maidaan me ab hazaron kursi thi. Khali nahi. Har kursi pe ek kaagaz-aadmi baitha tha. Aur har kaagaz-aadmi ke haath me ek ghadi.

Beech me sabse badi kursi pe woh pehla wala baitha tha - jo 17va ped bana tha. Par woh ped nahi raha. Wapas kaagaz-aadmi ban gaya tha. Usne humko dekha aur bola, bina muh hilaaye -

"Ped laga ke tumne gate band nahi kiye. Tumne gate dikha diye. Ab hume pata chal gaya

tumhari duniya me ped kahan ugte hain. Jahan ped hai, wahan hum aayenge. Kyunki wahan bachche aate hain."

Sujoy chillaya - "Matlab?"

Usne bola - "Hum thakan khate hain. Jaldrazi peete hain. Tumhari duniya me dono bohot hai.

School, coaching, exam, race... isiliye hum kabza karenge. Pehle gali se, phir park se, phir poore Patna se."

Tab samajh aaya - hum unko rok nahi rahe the. Hum unko rasta dikha rahe the. Har ped ek nishaan ban gaya tha unke liye.

Aditya bola - "Toh solution kya hai? Ped kaat de?"

Maine bola - "Nahi. Ped kaatne se thakan aur badhegi."

Himanshu bola - "Toh?"

Zameen ki screen pe ek aur cheez dikhi. Unke maidaan ke peeche ek darwaza tha. Bada sa.

Uspe likha tha - EXIT. Par woh band tha. Kyunki uspe 18 taale lage the. Har taala ek ped ke naam ka.

Sujoy samajh gaya - "Inko wapas bhejne ke liye inka darwaza kholna hoga. Par taale humare pedon se lage hain. Matlab pedon ko ukhaadna nahi, pedon ko..."

Main bola - "...pedon ko unki taraf bhejna hoga."

Sabne dekha. Har ped ki jadd zameen ke neeche se unke maidaan me jaa rahi thi. Hara network.

Plan ready tha.

Aage 19 mein

PART 19 ·

Patna Par Kabza

Subah 6 baje, Patna ki har gali se safed dhuaan nikla. Tanki wali gali jaisa.

DAV, Boring Road, Gandhi Maidan, har jagah ek geela circle bana. Har circle se ek kaagaz- aadmi nikla.

Log thak ke girne lage. Bina daud ke thak rahe the. Auto wala, sabzi wala, student sab.

News pe aaya - "Patna me ajeeb thakan ka virus."

Hum 6 dost - main, Sujoy, Aditya, Anuraag, Himanshu, Ajeya - 17 Ped Park me mile.

Sujoy bola - "Shuru ho gaya. Ye kabza hai."

Anuraag bola - "DAV me 400 bachche fase hain. Unko nikalna hai."

Himanshu bola - "Ek hi safe zone hai. Ye park. Kyunki yahan 18 ped ki jadd hai. Yahan abhi bhi thandak hai."

Hum 6 alag alag taraf bhaage.

Main Boring Road, Sujoy Kankarbagh, Aditya Patliputra, Himanshu Rajendra Nagar, Ajeya

Danapur, Anuraag DAV.

Shaam tak hum 300 logon ko le aaye. Bacche, buddhe, teacher, dukaan wale.

Park ke andar jaise hi aaye, unki thakan khatam. Kyunki 18 ped ki chhaya abhi bhi yahan thi, jadd ke roop me.

Park ke bahar poori Patna safed ho gaya tha. Kaagaz jaisa. Khali kursi wala maidaan ban gaya tha.

Park ke gate pe hum 6 khade the. Haath pakad ke.

Gate ke bahar hazaro kaagaz-aadmi khade the. Bol rahe the - "Nikal jao. Ye sheher hamara hai."

Maine bola - "Andar aake dikhao."

Koi andar nahi aa paya.

PART 20 ·

Sacrifice

Raat ke 12 baje kaagaz-aadmiyon ne park ka gate todna shuru kar diya.

300 log andar the. Bacche ro rahe the.

Sujoy bola - "Gate toot jayega. Ek ko bahar jaana hoga distraction ke liye."

Ajeya bola - "Main jaata hu."

Sujoy bola - "Nahi. Tu block karna jaanta hai. Main jaata hu."

Sujoy ne apni purani science wali notebook li. Usme usne saare circle ka map banaya tha.

Bola - "Main unko maidaan ki taraf le jaunga. Tab tak tu kaam kar."

Sujoy gate se bahar nikla. Chillaya - "Mujhe pakdo. Main hi Ansh hu. Jisne sabse pehle gate dekha tha."

Saare kaagaz-aadmi uske peeche bhaage. Patna ke safed maidaan ki taraf.

Tab Ajeya ne apna bag khola. Usme 18 ped ke beej nahi, namak tha. Aur paani.

Bola - "Purana method. Gali ko geela karna."

Usne park ke chaaro taraf gol gol namak wala paani daala. Wahi method jisse pehle gali band hoti thi.

Zameen ne paani piya aur ek bada neela circle bana. Poore park ke chaaro taraf.

Jaise hi circle pura hua, park ki zameen 2 foot upar uth gayi. Safe zone ban gaya.

Bahair se kaagaz-aadmi andar nahi aa paaye.

Par Sujoy wapas nahi aaya. Maidaan me kho gaya.

Ajeya ne circle pura karte hi bola - "Circle ko permanent karne ke liye ek ko andar rehna hoga."

Woh circle ke andar baith gaya. Namak wali zameen me.

Bola - "Mujhe yahin rehne do. Tab tak block rahega."

Circle ne usko pakad liya. Woh pathar jaisa ho gaya. 19va ped ban gaya. Namak wala ped.

Subah hui toh Patna wapas normal tha. Safed maidaan khatam. Gali khatam. 300 log bach gaye.

Par park me ab 19 ped the. Ek kaagaz jaisa, ek namak jaisa.

Aur beech wali bench pe do naam likhe the - Sujoy, Ajeya.

Himanshu bola - "Woh dono toh gaye."

Maine bola - "Nahi. Woh dono gate ban gaye."

PART 21 ·

Sab Theek

U ske baad sab theek ho gaya.

Patna normal. School normal. Park normal.

19 ped wapas 19 ped ban gaye. Hara bhara.

8th C ke bachche ab shortcut nahi lete. Lambe se jaate hain. Der se, par poore.

Hum 4 bache - main, Himanshu, Aditya, Anuraag - har Sunday park me milte hain. Beech wali bench pe.

Do chair khali rehti hai. Sujoy aur Ajeya ki.

Kabhi kabhi hawa chalti hai toh lagta hai woh dono bhi baithe hain.

Koi nayi gali nahi dikhti. Koi ghadi ulti nahi chalti.

Bas shaam ko jab bell bajti hai, toh 19 ped ke patte ek saath hilte hain.

Aur lagta hai sab poore pahuch gaye.

THE END

PART 22 ·

10 Saal Baad

10 saal beet gaye.

Hum sab settle ho gaye.

Mera ek beta hai - 9 saal ka. Ansh Jr.

Himanshu ki beti hai. Aditya ke judwa bachche. Anuraag ka ek beta.

Har Sunday hum park me milte hain. Biwi bachchon ke saath.

Park ab 19 Ped Park nahi, 19 Ped Family Park hai.

Us din Ansh Jr. daudte hue aaya. Bola - "Papa, wahan peeche ek gali dikhi. Chhoti si."

Hum chaaron ne ek dusre ko dekha. Wahi line. Wahi shuruwaat.

Par ab hum bhaage nahi.

Maine bola - "Beta, tu andar gaya?"

Ansh Jr. bola - "Nahi. Pehle aapko batane aaya."

Himanshu ki beti boli - "Mujhe bhi dikhi. Par main ruki hui hu."

Hum samajh gaye. Plot hole wapass khula hai. Par is baar dar nahi tha. Risk lena nahi tha.

Kyunki ab peeche family thi.

Aditya bola - "Ab humein jaane ki zarurat nahi. Ek successor chahiye."

Anuraag bola - "Kaun?"

Maine apne bete ko dekha. Usko dar nahi lag raha tha. Curiosity thi.

Maine bola - "Yehi."

Hum chaaron ne usko purana wala method sikhaya - paani nahi, intezaar. Namak nahi, nam.

Ansh Jr. ne apna haath aage kiya. Aur bola - "Main sambhal lunga, papa. Aap log baitho."

Woh gali ki taraf gaya. Par akela nahi. Uske saath Himanshu ki beti bhi thi.

Peeche hum chaar bench pe baithe the. Do khali chair ab bhi thi - Sujoy aur Ajeya ki.

Aur is baar hum dekhne wale the, karne wale nahi.

PART 22 · cont.

CONTINUED

Phir Se

Bacche gaye toh the, par wapas nahi aaye.

10 minute ho gaye. 20 minute.

Gali jahan thi, wahan ab safed dhuaan tha.

Ansh Jr. ki awaaz aayi andar se - "Papa, andar chipchip hai! Pair pakad raha hai!"

Himanshu ki beti chilla rahi thi - "Uncle, nikal nahi paa rahe!"

Hum chaaron 40 saal ke ho gaye the. Pet nikal aaya tha. Ghutne dukhte the. Par uthna pada.

Maine bola - "Chalo."

Aditya sabse aage bhaaga. Bola - "Mere bachche andar hain."

Hum chaaron gali me ghuse. Wahi purana method. Geela circle. Thandi zameen.

Bacche beech me fase the. Unke pair safed mitti ne pakad liye the.

Himanshu aur Anuraag ne bachchon ko khincha.

Maine aur Aditya ne circle ke chaaro taraf paani daala. Purana wala.

Zameen ne chhoda, par ek jhatka maara.

Bacche nikal gaye.

Par Aditya ka pair nahi nikla. Usne jaldi me ek galat jagah kadam rakh diya tha. Jahan pehle namak wala ped tha.

Woh bola - "Tum log niklo. Main rokta hu."

Maine uska haath pakda. Par woh chhoota nahi. Zameen ne usko pakad liya tha.

Usne apne bachchon ko dekha aur bola - "Lambe se jaana, beta. Shortcut mat lena."

Gali band ho gayi. Ek tez hawa ke saath.

Bacche bahar the. Hum teen bahar the.

Aditya andar reh gaya.

Park me ab 20 ped the.

Beench pe ab 3 khali chair thi - Sujoy, Ajeya, Aditya.

Hum me ab woh baat nahi rahi thi. Hum 40 ke ho gaye the. Daud nahi paate the. Par us din samajh aaya, baap banne ke baad daudna nahi, rokna padta hai.

Ansh Jr. ne pucha - "Aditya uncle kahan gaye?"

Maine bola - "Woh bhi gate ban gaye. Hamare liye."

PART 23 ·

Ek Galti

Aditya ke jaane ke ek hafte baad, humne ek galti kar di.

Himanshu ne us jagah ko khod diya jahan Aditya fasa tha. Bola - "Uska joota nikal lete hain.

Yaad ke liye."

Khodte hi zameen phir se geeli ho gayi. Ek naya circle khul gaya. Bada wala.

Us circle ke upar Aditya ka hi ghar tha. Uske biwi bachche usi ghar me the.

Subah news aayi - poora ghar safed. Andar koi nahi. Na biwi, na bachche. Jaise mitti ne nigal liya ho. Ek parivar ujad gaya. Hamari galti se.

Aur uske baad Patna ka incursion hilne laga. Matlab jo safe zone tha, woh collapse karne laga.

Park ki zameen phatne lagi. 20 ped hilne lage.

Hum library gaye. Khuda Bakhsh Library. Sinha Library. Har jagah kitaab khoji.

Har kitaab me ek hi line thi - "Ek khula gate, ek band gate se hi band hota hai. Ek ko gate banna padega."

Himanshu ne kitaab band ki. Bola - "Aditya mera bhai tha. Uski family meri wajah se gayi.

Main banoonga gate."

Maine bola - "Mat kar."

Himanshu bola - "Rasta ek hi hai. Main tyaar hu."

Usne apni biwi aur beti ko park ke bahar bhej diya. Bola - "Wapas mat aana jab tak main bulaau nahi."

Aur woh uss naye circle me jaa ke baith gaya. Beech me. Jahan Aditya ka ghar tha.

Bola - "Ab band kar do."

Humne uspe mitti daalni shuru ki.

PART 23 · cont.

CONTINUED

Sab Theek

Humne mitti daali. Namak wala paani daala.

Himanshu beech me baitha raha. Hila nahi.

Bola - "Jaldi karo. Hil raha hai."

Zameen ne usko dheere dheere pakad liya. Pair, phir kamar, phir kandha.

Jaise hi uska sar mitti me gaya, ek jhatka laga.

Ek tez roshni aayi. Aur phir sab shaant.

Jab aankh khuli toh park wapas hara tha. Circle band tha.

Samne Aditya ka ghar wapas tha. Uske biwi bachche ghar ke andar. So rahe the. Jaise kuch hua hi na ho. Parivar wapas jud gaya.

Patna ka incursion collapse ruk gaya. Zameen jud gayi.

Park me ab 21 ped the. Himanshu wala sabse seedha.

Bench pe ab 4 khali chair thi - Sujoy, Ajeya, Aditya, Himanshu.

Main aur Anuraag bache the. 40 saal ke, thake hue.

Anuraag bola - "Sab thik hua kya?"

Maine bola - "Haan. Par hamari keemat pe."

Bachche park me khel rahe the. Aditya ke bachche bhi. Himanshu ki beti bhi. Unko kuch yaad nahi tha.

Bas hum do ko yaad tha - ek galti, ek gate, aur ek dost jo gate ban gaya.

Us din ke baad Patna me koi gali kabhi chhoti nahi hui.

Lambe raste hi lambe rahe.

Aur safe.

PART 24 ·

Bees Saal Baad

Bees saal aur beet gaye.

Hum 60 ke ho gaye. Main aur Anuraag. Baaki sab ped ban gaye - Sujoy, Ajeya, Aditya,

Himanshu.

Park ab bhi tha. Beech beech me chhote chhote plot hole dikhte the. Kabhi jhoola ke neeche, kabhi tap ke paas. Par koi bada gate nahi khula.

Ek din main aur Anuraag park pahuche. Wahi bench. 4 khali chair ab bhi khali.

Tab dekha, ek bacha ghum raha tha. 10 saal ka. Apne dada ke saath.

Dada ki umar hamare jitni. 60 saal. Chehre pe nishaan. Aankhein jaani pehchani.

Baccha bola - "Dada, yahan 21 ped kyun hain? Sab jagah 20 hote hain."

Dada ne has ke bola - "Ye 4 dost hain. Aur ye do uncle bhi unke dost hain."

Hum chaunk gaye. Usse kaise pata?

Main bola - "Aap kaun?"

Dada ne apni topi utari. Bola - "Pehchana nahi? Main Sameer."

Sameer. 8th C ka Sameer. Jo pehle hi chala gaya tha. Jiske baare me humne socha tha kho gaya.

Anuraag bola - "Tu zinda hai?"

Sameer bola - "Haan. Main gate ke us paar chala gaya tha. Tab se main dekh raha tha. Mujhe pehle se hi sab pata tha. Isliye main chala gaya tha. Taki ek bacha rahe jo yaad rakhe."

Uska pota tha saath me. Naam - Aarav.

Sameer bola - "Main isko taiyaar kar raha hu. Aane wali chunotiyon ke liye. Kyunki plot hole kabhi khatam nahi hote. Bas sote hain."

Aarav hamare paas aaya. Bola - "Uncle, aap log thak gaye ho. Ab meri baari."

Usne bench pe rakhi 4 khali chair ko dekha aur ek naya phool rakha.

Main samajh gaya. Successor mil gaya. Koi aur nahi, Sameer ka pota.

Purane gate ke rakhwale ko naya rakhwala mil gaya.

Hum dono muskuraye. Pehli baar 20 saal me chain se bench pe baithe.

Park me 21 ped hawa me hil rahe the. Jaise dost haath hila rahe ho.

PART 24 · cont.

CONTINUED

Pote

Hum baat kar hi rahe the ki peeche se paanv ki aahat aayi.

Mud ke dekha toh teen bache khade the.

Mera pota - Ansh Jr. ka beta, Chintu. 12 saal ka.

Anuraag ka pota - Veer.

Aur Aditya aur Himanshu ke pote bhi. Dono saath.

Chintu bola - "Dada, hum sab sun rahe the. Peeche se."

Veer bola - "Aap log gate, ped, sacrifice ki baat kar rahe ho na?"

Aditya ka pota bola - "Humein bhi pata hai. Papa ne bataya tha. Lambe se jaana."

Sameer ka pota Aarav unko dekh ke hasa. Bola - "To team puri hai?"

Char pote, ek saath aage aa gaye. Bench ke saamne khade ho gaye.

Main bola - "Tum logon ko dar nahi lagta?"

Chintu bola - "Lagta hai. Par aap log 40 saal ki umar me gaye the. Hum 12 ke hain. Daud sakte hain."

Anuraag ki aankhon me aansu the. Bola - "Dekh, hamare pote bhi wahi kar rahe hain jo hum karte the."

Sameer bola - "Yahi toh chahiye tha. Successor ek nahi, chaar mil gaye."

Us din park me 6 buzurg baithe the - main, Anuraag, Sameer. Aur 4 khali chair ab bhi thi.

Aur saamne 5 bache khade the - hamara naya circle.

21 ped ke neeche, nayi kahani shuru hone ko thi. Par is baar akeli nahi, poori team ke saath.

Maine bola - "Theek hai. Kal se training. Pehla rule - shortcut mat lena."

Saare bache ek saath bole - "Lambe se jayenge, Dada!"

PART 25 ·

Last Part - Ant

Aaj bhi wohi plots aate hain.

Kabhi chhote, jhoole ke neeche. Kabhi bade, maidaan ke beech.

Par ab dar nahi lagta.

Kyunki saviours ready hain.

5 bache - Chintu, Veer, Aarav, aur Aditya-Himanshu ke pote. Roz shaam ko park me aate hain.

Circle banana seekhte hain. Namak wala paani, intezaar wala method.

Hum teen buzurg - main, Anuraag, Sameer - bench pe baithe unhe samjhate hain.

Main bolta hu - "Daudna mat, rokna."

Anuraag bolta hai - "Akela mat jaana, saath jaana."

Sameer bolta hai - "Gate ko dekhna, andar mat ghusna jab tak zarurat na ho."

Aur woh sunte hain. Haan me sar hilate hain. Kabhi haste hain. Kabhi hamari nakal karte hain.

Har kahani ka ek ant hota hai.

Shayad yahan bhi time aa chuka tha.

Kal doctor ne bola - mera time kam hai. Anuraag ka bhi. Sameer toh pehle se hi thaka hua tha.

Humne 5 bachchon ko bulaya. Bench pe bithaya.

Maine bola - "Ab ye park tumhara. Ye 21 ped tumhare dost. Aur ye 4 khali chair..."

Chintu bola - "Khali nahi rahegi, Dada. Aap log ke baad hum baithege. Aur hamare baad

hamare bache."

Us din hum samajh gaye. Kahani khatam nahi hoti. Bas bench badalta hai.

Shaam ko bell baji. 21 ped ek saath hile.

Hum teen ne aankhein band ki. Peeche bachchon ki hasi thi.

Plot hole aata rahega. Par Patna me lambe raste pe chalne wale bhi hamesha rahenge.

THE END - PAR ASAL ME SHURUWAAT

PART 26 ·

Ek Aakhri Part - 22 Ped Nahi, 25

Tumhe laga kahani khatam ho gayi? Nahi.

Us raat ke baad main aur Anuraag aur Sameer so gaye. Hamesha ke liye. Ek hi raat me.

Teenon bench pe hi.

Subah jab 5 pote park pahuche, dekha bench khali thi.

Par ped gine toh chaunk gaye.

Kal tak 21 ped the. Aaj 24 the.

Teen naye ped, bench ke sabse paas. Bilkul seedhe. Jaise abhi bhi baith ke dekh rahe hon.

Chintu samajh gaya. Rone laga, phir hasne laga.

Veer bola - "Dada log gaye nahi. Ped ban gaye."

Aarav ne apni jeb se wahi purani diary nikali jo Sameer ne di thi. Aakhri panna khola. Wahan likha tha -

"Jab hum bhi ped ban jayein, toh ginti karna band kar dena. Kyunki park kabhi 19 ped ka tha hi nahi. Wo hamesha badhta rahega."

5 bachchon ne 4 khali chair ko dekha. Ab 7 khali chair thi.

Par ab wo khali nahi lag rahi thi.

Aarav sabse pehle bench pe baitha. Bola -

"Chalo, pehla rule - shortcut kabhi mat lena."

Baaki chaar bole - "Lambe se jayenge!"

Hawa chali. 25 ped ek saath hile.

Aur park ke bahar, Patna ki ek gali jo kal tak chhoti ho rahi thi, wapas lambi ho gayi.

THE END

PART 27 ·

20 Years Later

Bees saal aur beet gaye.

Patna ab bahut badal gaya. Park ke charo taraf building ban gayi. Par park ke andar koi building nahi bana saka. Thekedaar aate, nishaan lagate, par subah tak 25 ped 26 ho jaate.

Ab park me koi nahi jaata tha. Bas 5 ladke jaate the.

Chintu, Veer, Aarav aur do.

Ab wo 32 saal ke the. Chintu ki shaadi ho gayi thi. Uska ek beta tha - 4 saal ka.

Ek din Chintu apne bete ko park leke aaya. Dada ki bench pe bithaya.

Beta bola - "Papa, yahan kitne ped hain?"

Chintu ne gina. 25.

Tabhi peeche se ek buzurg ki awaaz aayi.

"26."

Mud ke dekha toh ek ladka khada tha. 20 saal ka. Same height, same aankhein.

Veer bola - "Tu kaun?"

Ladka bola - "Main us parivaar ka pota hu, jo Himanshu uncle ki galti se... yaad hai? Jisko aapke dada logon ne bachaya tha."

Sab shock.

Us ladke ne bola - "Mere dada ne bola tha, Patna ke us park me 5 bhaiya rehte hain jo bina naam ke raksha karte hain. Main unke liye aaya hu."

Tabhi zameen hili. Park ke beech me ek bada plot hole khula. Bees saal me sabse bada.

5 dost dar gaye. Chintu ka beta rone laga.

Naye ladke ne apne haath se mitti uthayi aur hole me daal di. Bola - "Darne ka nahi. Banna ka hai."

Chintu ne apne bete ko bench ke neeche chhupaya aur bola - "Aarav, circle bana!"

6 ladke, ek circle. Beech me 4 saal ka bacha.

Aur 25 ped ke beech me, ek nayi kahani ne aankh kholi.

Same park. Same plot. Par saviours ab bhi ready the.

PART 28 ·

City Se State Tak

20 saal aur. City se state ban gaya.

Patna ke baad Gaya, Muzaffarpur, Bhagalpur. Har jagah wahi chhote chhote plot hole nikalne lage. Jaise Patna wala park ab fail raha ho.

Log bolne lage - "Bihar me zameen khisak rahi hai."

News wale bolte - "Sinkhole."

Par hum 6 jante the - ye plot hole hai.

Ab hum 50 ke ho gaye the. Chintu, Veer, Aarav aur wo naya ladka - Aman. 6th wala Sameer ka

pota.

Hum Bihar ke har park me jaate. Wahi kaam. Circle, namak wala paani, intezaar. Kabhi jeet jaate, kabhi ek ped aur badh jaata.

Log humein pagal bolte. "Ped wale baba."

Par attitude wahi tha.

Chintu ab bhi bolta tha - "Lambe se jayenge."

Veer ab bhi bolta tha - "Daudna mat."

Aarav ab bhi diary likhta tha. Us diary me ab 89 ped ke naam the. Har ped ek dost. Sujoy,

Ajeya, Aditya, Himanshu, Anuraag, Sameer, Ansh...

Ek din Chintu ke bete ne, jo ab 24 saal ka tha, bola - "Papa, aap kab tak ped ginoge? Sarkar ko bol do."

Chintu hasa. Usne apne bete ke kandhe pe haath rakha aur wahi bench dikhai jo ab Patna se

300km door ek jungle me thi.

Bola - "Sarkar map badal sakti hai. Park nahi. Attitude toh wahi rahega na. Shortcut nahi lena."

Usi raat Bihar me ek saath 10 plot hole khule. Sabse bada attack.

Hum 6 alag alag sheher me the. Phone pe bas ek hi baat boli -

"Apna apna circle sambhalo."

20 saal beet gaye city ko state bachate. Par hum thake nahi. Kyunki hum jaante the, jab tak ek bhi bacha bolega "lambe se jayenge", tab tak state bhi bachega.

PART 28 · ext.

EXTENDED

50 Members

Usi raat jab 10 plot hole ek saath khule, toh Chintu ko samajh aa gaya, ab 6 se kaam nahi chalega.

Usne phone uthaya aur ek group call kiya - "Ped Gang - Bihar"

50 members. Pure state me faile hue.

Har member kisi na kisi ped ka pota tha. Kisi ke dada Sujoy the, kisi ke Himanshu.

Aur ab un sab me power aa gayi thi. Supernatural. Kyunki wo ped sirf ped nahi the.

Chintu ki power - Rokna. Jahan haath rakhe, zameen 10 minute ke liye pathar ban jaaye.

Plot hole khul na sake.

Veer ki power - Dekhna. Usko pehle se dikh jaata tha ki agla hole kahan khulega. Aankhein band karte hi map dikhta tha.

Aarav ki power - Yaad. Diary ko chhoote hi usko us ped ke aadmi ki poori kahani yaad aa jaati. Kaise mra, kya bolna chahta tha.

Aman ki power - Banna. Wo khud 5 minute ke liye gate ban sakta tha. Hole ko apne andar leke band kar deta.

Baaki 46 members me bhi chhoti chhoti powers. Koi hawa rok de, koi bachchon ko invisible kar de.

Us raat Chintu chilla ke bola - State group me -

"Sun lo sab. Aaj Bihar bachaana hai. Shortcut koi nahi lega. Sab apne apne park me circle banao!"

50 jagah, ek saath 50 circle bane. Patna se Kishanganj tak.

10 plot hole chillaye, khule, par band ho gaye.

Kyunki is baar ek ped nahi, poora jungle lad raha tha.

Chintu ka beta jo sab dekh raha tha, bola - "Papa, aap log superhero ho?"

Chintu hasa, wahi purana attitude me -

"Superhero nahi. Bas lambe raste wale ladke. Ped ke bachche."

Aur us raat ke baad Bihar me pehli baar 1 mahine tak ek bhi plot hole nahi khula.

PART 29 ·

Rasta Khula

Ek mahine baad. Sannata tha. Sabko laga jeet gaye.

Tabhi Patna wale park me beech wala ped, jo sabse pehle Sujoy bana tha, hilne laga.

Chintu dauda. Veer, Aarav sab aaye.

Ped ki chhaal se ek darar nikli. Andar se roshni.

Rasta khula.

Wahi rasta jo bees saal pehle band hua tha. Jahaan Sujoy, Ajeya, Aditya jaise log saalon se khade the. Gate banke.

Chintu ne andar jhaanka.

Andar koi nahi tha.

Gate khali the. Ped ke andar khokhle. Jaise koi pehle hi chala gaya ho.

Veer bola - "Ye kaise? Unki power toh yahan thi."

Aarav ne diary kholi. Aakhri panna khud se likh raha tha -

"Hum thak gaye. Bahut saal khade rahe. Ab tum log bade ho gaye. Ab humein jaana hoga."

Chintu chilla ke bola - "Sujoy! Ajeya! Kahan ho?"

Koi jawab nahi. Bas hawa me ek aakhri awaaz aayi, Sujoy ki -

"Ab rasta tumhara hai. Hum lambe se chale gaye."

Rasta khula tha, par pehredar nahi the.

Matlab ab koi gate nahi tha. Plot hole seedha bahar aa sakta tha. Bina rok ke.

Aman bola - "To ab kya karein?"

Chintu ne apna haath us khali ped pe rakha. Bola - "Ab hum khade honge."

50 members me se 4 aage aaye. Bole - "Hum bhi."

Uss din 4 naye ped bane. Par is baar zabardasti nahi. Marzi se.

Aur rasta phir band ho gaya. Par ab uske peeche Sujoy nahi, Chintu ke 4 dost khade the.

PART 30 ·

The Real Last - Hamesha Ke Liye Khatam

Fir Chintu ko samajh aaya. Jab tak koi khada rahega, rasta band rahega. Par kahani khatam nahi hogi. Ek ke baad ek ped bante rahenge.

Ye khatam karna hai toh gate ko band nahi, todna padega.

Usne 50 members ko bulaya. 25 ped ke chaaro taraf.

Aarav bola - "Diary me ek aakhri tareeka likha hai. Agar saare ped ek saath apni power chhod dein, toh rasta hamesha ke liye khatam."

Matlab saare dost... Sujoy, Ajeya, Aditya, Himanshu, Anuraag, Sameer... sab hamesha ke liye chale jayenge. Na ped rahenge, na yaad.

Veer bola - "To kar dein?"

Chintu ki aankhon me aansu the. Usne apne bete ko dekha. Jo ab uski god me tha.

Bola - "Haan. Bahut ho gaya lambe raste. Ab bachchon ko seedha rasta milna chahiye."

50 members ne ek saath haath rakha. 25 pedon pe.

Chintu chilla ke bola -

"Aaj se koi lambe se nahi jayega! Sab apne ghar seedha jayenge!"

Ek tez roshni. Pure Bihar me.

Saare ped ek saath gir gaye. Na awaaz, na dhool. Bas hawa me khushboo.

Plot hole jahan tha, wahan ab ek chhota talab ban gaya. Saaf paani.

Sujoy, Ajeya sabki awaaz ek baar aayi - "Thank you."

Agli subah Patna ke us park me sirf ek bench thi. Ek khali maidaan. Ek bhi ped nahi. Ek bhi plot hole nahi.

Chintu ka beta dauda, seedha maidaan ke beech se. Shortcut se. Aur kuch nahi hua.

Wo has ke bola - "Papa, dekho kuch nahi hua!"

Chintu roya, par iss baar khushi se. Bola - "Haan beta. Ab kuch nahi hoga. Hamesha ke liye khatam."

KAHANI SAMAPT



*Shortcut ab safe tha. Kyunki kisi ne lambe raste pe poori zindagi
chalna manzoor kiya tha.*

VOLUME 1 · ENDS — PAR ASAL ME SHURUWAAT

THE GATES · VOLUME 1

“Der se pahucho, par poora pahucho.”

पूरा पहुँचो।
आगे पीढ़ी के लिए।

A short novel by **Ansh Jha** and Cooperators · Patna, 2026
Foreword by Chintu · Volume 2 dictation shared by Punita Jha
Cover art by the author · Typeset edition — story text unchanged.

SUPERHERO WOHI HAI JO KHADA REHTA HAI.